

The Noble Sūtra of the Great Vehicle Called the Chapter of Kāśyapa

Āryakāśyapaparivarta nāma mahāyānasūtra · Toh 87 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་འདོ་སངས་གསུང་ཞུ་བ་ལྟ་བུ་བསྒྲུབ།

The Kāśyapaparivarta, known in Sanskrit as the Āryakāśyapaparivarta and in Tibetan as འཕགས་པ་འདོ་སངས་གསུང་ཞུ་བ་ལྟ་བུ་བསྒྲུབ། (Pakpa Ösung gi Zhüpa), is a Mahāyāna sūtra in which the venerable Mahākāśyapa poses questions to the Buddha on Vulture Peak Mountain before a vast assembly of monks and bodhisattvas. The text is notable as the forty-third chapter of the great Mahāratnakūṭa collection, a compendium of one hundred thousand chapters, and it contains a prophecy delivered in response to Kāśyapa's inquiries, touching on themes central to Mahāyāna practice and understanding. It is catalogued as Toh 87 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the general class of Mahāyāna sūtra literature, and its standalone transmission under the title "Chapter of Kāśyapa" reflects the enduring importance this particular discourse held as an independent scripture across the Buddhist traditions of India and Tibet.

From the noble great Mahāratnakūṭa Dharma-treasury, in one hundred thousand chapters, this is the forty-third chapter: the prophecy given in response to the questions of the noble Kāśyapa. The first fascicle.

In the language of India: Āryakāśyapaparivarta nāma mahāyānasūtra.

In the Tibetan language: The Noble Sūtra of the Great Vehicle Called the Chapter of Kāśyapa.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Rājagṛha on Vulture Peak Mountain, together with a great Saṅgha of eight thousand monks and sixty-thousand bodhisattvas gathered from various buddha-fields — each and every one of them standing but one birth away from unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. At that time the Venerable Mahākāśyapa had also assembled in that same retinue and was seated there.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the Venerable Mahākāśyapa: Kāśyapa, the following four things cause a bodhisattva's wisdom to deteriorate. What are the four? They are these: showing no respect for the Dharma and for those who teach the Dharma; being miserly with the Dharma and holding onto the Dharma teacher's examples and illustrations as though they were one's own;

creating obstacles to the Dharma for those who desire it, turning them away from their aspiration, causing them confusion, and refusing to teach while being thoroughly deceitful; and, out of manifest pride, praising oneself while disparaging others. Kāśyapa, these four things cause a bodhisattva's wisdom to deteriorate.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Showing no respect for those who teach the Dharma,
becoming miserly with the Dharma,
and holding onto the teacher's examples as one's own;
creating obstacles for those who seek the Dharma,
turning away their aspiration and likewise causing them confusion;
not teaching the Dharma praised by the Victors —
that lazy one strives only to constantly praise himself
and delights in disparaging others.

The Victors have declared that these four things
cause the wisdom of the sons of the Victors to deteriorate.
Therefore, having completely abandoned these four things,
cultivate the other four that the Victors have taught.

Kāśyapa, the following four things cause a bodhisattva's wisdom to become great. What are the four? They are these: showing respect for the Dharma and for those who teach the Dharma; with a mind free of materialism, without expectation of gain, honor, or verse-offerings, teaching others the Dharma just as one has heard it and just as one has understood it, widely and correctly; knowing that wisdom arises from extensive learning, seeking learning everywhere, as though one's head or robes were on fire, and retaining the teachings just as one has heard them; taking what is essential as essential through diligent practice, and not merely busying oneself with words and expressions. Kāśyapa, these four things cause a bodhisattva's wisdom to become great.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Showing respect for those who teach the Dharma,
free of materialism, with no expectation of gain, honor,
or verse-offerings, teaching others
the teachings just as one has heard them;
knowing that wisdom arises from learning,
always seeking teachings as though one's head were ablaze;

retaining the teachings just as one has heard them,
and dwelling in order to practice them with diligence —
the wise one takes what is essential as essential,
and does not busy oneself with words or with speaking.
If the wise cultivate these four things,
they will attain the wisdom praised by the Victors.

Kāśyapa, if a bodhisattva is endowed with four things, the awakening mind will be forgotten. What are the four? They are these: a teacher and

a field of generosity — deceiving them; inducing regret in others who have no cause for regret; composing and reciting verses of dispraise, unpleasant and ungracious words about sentient beings who have genuinely entered the Great Vehicle; and engaging with others through deceit and duplicity rather than through sincere intention. Kāśyapa, if a bodhisattva is endowed with these four things, the awakening mind will be forgotten.

Concerning this, it is said:

Not doing what one's teacher and field of generosity direct,
and inducing doubt and regret in others;
toward those sentient beings who have truly entered into awakening,
speaking dispraise and unpleasant words;
through deceit and duplicity, adorning oneself for the sake of gain,
relying on others not out of sincere intention —
if one continually relies upon these four things,
the supreme awakening mind of the buddhas will be degraded.
Therefore, whoever relies upon these practices
will move far from the supreme awakening.
But whoever relies upon the opposite of these
will come to touch the supreme awakening, so greatly praised.

Kāśyapa, if a bodhisattva is endowed with four things, the awakening mind will manifest in every birth the moment one is born, and from that point until one sits at the seat of awakening, it will never be cast aside or forgotten. What are the four? They are these: not speaking false words even for the sake of one's life, or even for the sake of laughter; dwelling before all sentient beings with sincere intention, free from deceit and duplicity; generating the perception of all bodhisattvas as teachers and proclaiming their true praise in all four directions; and, because one does not desire the inferior vehicle, leading to full

ripening all those sentient beings one is maturing, and guiding each and every one of them to take up unsurpassed perfect and complete awakening. Kāśyapa, a bodhisattva endowed with these four things will, in every birth, manifest the awakening mind the moment one is born, and from that point until one sits at the seat of awakening, it will never be cast aside or forgotten.

Concerning this, it is said:

Never speaking false words even for one's life,
always speaking words that carry true meaning;
always entirely abandoning deceit and duplicity,
and always regarding sentient beings with sincere intention;
whatever pure sentient being has entered into awakening —
perceiving that bodhisattva as a teacher,
and, having established the perception of a teacher firmly within,
proclaiming their praise in all four directions;
leading those sentient beings one is maturing to full ripening,
guiding them to take up the unsurpassed gnosis —
those who abide steadfastly in these qualities
will never at any time forget the awakening mind.

Kāśyapa, if a bodhisattva is endowed with four things, whatever wholesome qualities have arisen and emerged will be utterly exhausted, and those wholesome qualities will not flourish and expand. What are the four? They are these: seeking the secret words of worldly spells out of arrogance and conceit; attending to households with excessive attachment to gain and honour; harboring hatred and contempt toward bodhisattvas and disparaging them; and abandoning sūtras one has not yet heard or not yet grasped. Kāśyapa, if a bodhisattva is endowed with these four things, whatever wholesome qualities have arisen and emerged will be utterly exhausted, and those wholesome qualities will not flourish and expand.

Concerning this, it is said:

Through arrogance, one seeks the secret words of worldly spells;
for the sake of gain, one occupies oneself with households;
one harbors hatred toward bodhisattvas, the children of the buddhas,
and continually speaks their dispraise;
one abandons sūtras not yet heard and not yet grasped —
sūtras spoken by the Sugata (the Well-Gone, an epithet of the Buddha).

One endowed with these qualities will not flourish through virtuous Dharma. Therefore a wise bodhisattva thoroughly abandons these four things from afar. If they are cultivated, awakening recedes ever further — further even than the distance between sky and earth.

Kāśyapa, if a bodhisattva is endowed with four things, he advances excellently and becomes one whose qualities are never diminished. What are the four? They are as follows.

Endowed with the six perfections, he sets out to seek the scriptural collection of the bodhisattva, and in seeking to hear it well he does not seek out faults. Because he harbors no arrogance toward any sentient being, his mind is like that of a dog. He is content with gains obtained through the Dharma, he entirely abandons every form of wrong livelihood, and he is content to abide in the lineage of the noble ones. He does not speak of the transgressions of others — whether they have arisen or not — and he does not search out the errors of others and broadcast them abroad. As for those profound qualities of the Buddha that his own intellect fails to comprehend, he does not abandon them, thinking, "The awakening of the buddhas is boundless; the Tathāgatas teach the Dharma in accordance with the different dispositions of sentient beings; the Tathāgatas themselves know, but I do not — the Tathāgatas perceive directly." Kāśyapa, if a bodhisattva is endowed with these four things, he advances excellently and becomes one whose qualities are never diminished.

Concerning this, it is said:

Ever striving for the perfections,
for skillful means, and for the bodhisattva scriptural collection,
with a mind humble as a dog, free from arrogance,
he has broken down pride before every sentient being.

Content with gains accordant with the Dharma,
his livelihood wholly pure, he dwells in the lineage of the noble ones.
He does not go seeking out the errors of others,
nor does he speak of the transgressions of others.

Whatever he cannot comprehend with his own mind —
there the Tathāgata perceives directly.
The awakening proclaimed by the Sugata is boundless;
it is known by the Victor, but I do not know it.

One who has come to understand these four qualities
possesses supreme wisdom that never diminishes.

One who is firmly established in these qualities
will not find it difficult to attain the awakening praised by the Victors.

Kāśyapa, these next four are the hallmarks of a deceitful awakening mind, and a bodhisattva must entirely abandon them. What are the four? They are as follows: harboring doubt, uncertainty, and hesitation toward the qualities of the buddhas; holding arrogance, conceit, dissimulation, anger, and harmful intent toward sentient beings; entertaining envy and miserliness toward the gains of others; and composing verses that are not praise, that are unpleasant, and that are words unfitting to be said about bodhisattvas. Kāśyapa, these four are the hallmarks of a deceitful awakening mind, and a bodhisattva must entirely abandon them.

Concerning this, it is said:

One doubts and wavers concerning the qualities of the Dharma;
toward sentient beings one leans on arrogance, conceit, and anger;
toward the gains of others one practices miserliness and envy;
toward the Victor one never generates faith.

The unwise, ever against the bodhisattvas,
speaks what is no praise, what should not be said, and what is unpleasant to hear.

Let the bodhisattva thoroughly abandon these four hallmarks of a deceitful mind,
and ever attend to sentient beings.

Kāśyapa, these next four are the defining characteristics of a bodhisattva's uprightness and rectitude. What are the four? They are as follows: not concealing transgressions that have arisen, but confessing and analyzing them, and not being overcome again by attachment. The words of truth — whatever truth-telling causes one to lose a kingdom, lose wealth, or —

even at the cost of one's life, one does not abandon words of truth, and one does not speak words that shift from one thing to another. When others inflict harm — through disparagement, exposure of faults, reviling, humiliation, censure, striking, killing, or imprisonment — one regards all such wrongs as one's own fault, and by relying on the karmic maturation of one's own actions, one does not quarrel with others and bears no grudge. One abides firmly in faith, and with a mind wholly pure in intention, one has confident faith in the

Dharma of the buddhas which does not waver in its faith through any cause. Kāśyapa, these four are the defining characteristics of a bodhisattva's uprightness and rectitude.

Concerning this, it is said:

One does not conceal a transgression that has arisen,
but confesses it, analyses it, and acknowledges the fault.
Even for the sake of wealth, a kingdom, or one's very life,
one does not alter one's intention and speak words of falsehood.

When one is disparaged, reviled, humiliated, or killed,
imprisoned, or placed in chains,
one regards it as one's own fault and does not quarrel with others;
knowing the deed is one's own, one bears no grudge.

This is abiding in the awakening of the Sugatas,
remaining in faith with a pure intention.
These, the buddhas have taught, are the marks of rectitude;
the foremost among sentient beings should ever attend to them.

Kāśyapa, these next four are the defining characteristics of a bodhisattva's heedlessness. What are the four? They are as follows: one abides in the way of abandoning what is dear in learning and does not apply oneself diligently to practicing the Dharma in accord with the Dharma. One abides in the way of abandoning what is dear in instruction and does not offer respectful service to one's teachers and preceptors. Though one has fallen from one's pledge, one consumes all around the food that has been given through faith, and one causes what has been given through faith to go to waste. When one sees bodhisattvas of good conduct, one is disrespectful and holds arrogant pride. Kāśyapa, these four are the hallmarks of a bodhisattva's heedlessness.

Concerning this, it is said:

One who abides in heedlessness through learning
will never come to realize the nature of the instructed Dharma.
Such a one clings to abandoning what is dear in all Dharmas
and never offers respectful service to the noble ones.

Though fallen from one's pledge, one constantly eats
the food given through faith by the faithful.
When one sees bodhisattvas who have attained good conduct,
one is disrespectful, and this heedlessness only swells one's pride.

Do not attend to the bodhisattva who has broken pride —
these are what the Sugata has taught as heedlessness;
the children of the Victor must utterly abandon them.

Kāśyapa, these next four are the defining characteristics of a bodhisattva's good conduct. What are the four? They are as follows: one listens well, applies oneself to it diligently, and relies on the meaning rather than the words. One holds instruction and teaching as concordant, and performs actions that are pleasing to one's guru with a gentle, obedient mind, serving the teacher thoroughly. One eats food without falling away from moral discipline and meditative absorption, sustained by good conduct. When one sees bodhisattvas of good conduct, one approaches them with respect and with veneration, draws near to them, comes close to them, and desires their good qualities. Kāśyapa, these four are the hallmarks of a bodhisattva's good conduct.

Concerning this, it is said:

One who listens attentively truly hears well,
takes the Dharma's meaning to heart, and abides in diligence.
One holds the teaching as concordant and, eager for the Dharma,
attends the teacher with a gentle, obedient mind.

One abides constantly in moral discipline and meditative absorption,
and having gathered oneself through ethical conduct, eats one's food.
One is respectful and full of veneration,
drawing near, coming close, and desiring good qualities.

Those children of the Victor who have attained good conduct —
upon them, look ever with joy.

These four teachings given by the Sugata are what the sons of the Sugata
come to know and attain.

Kāśyapa, these four are the errors of a bodhisattva. What are the four? They are as follows: placing reliance on sentient beings who have not yet been fully ripened is an error of a bodhisattva; teaching the vast Dharma of the buddhas to sentient beings who are not yet suitable vessels is an error of a bodhisattva; teaching the Lesser Vehicle to sentient beings who are devoted to the Great Vehicle is an error of a bodhisattva; and despising those who are genuinely established in virtue, who possess moral discipline and wholesome qualities,

while instead gathering around oneself those who are lax in their discipline and possessed of unwholesome qualities — this is an error of a bodhisattva. Kāśyapa, these four are the errors of a bodhisattva.

Concerning this, it is said:

Do not rely on those not yet fully ripened.

Do not teach the vast Dharma to those who are not suitable vessels.

To those who aspire to the Great Vehicle, the supreme bodhisattva should not teach the Lesser Vehicle.

Do not despise those truly established in virtue,
who possess the qualities of moral discipline and wholesome Dharma.

Do not gather around oneself beings who are lax in discipline —
fully abandon all unwholesome qualities.

Having understood these four erroneous qualities,
a bodhisattva must cast them far away and entirely abandon them.

If one teaches these, one will not awaken to buddhahood —
therefore, the wise should abandon these qualities.

Kāśyapa, these four are the path of a bodhisattva. What are the four? They are as follows: maintaining an even mind toward all sentient beings; teaching the Dharma impartially to all sentient beings; leading all sentient beings to take up the authentic wisdom of the buddhas; and engaging rightly with all sentient beings. Kāśyapa, these four are the path of a bodhisattva.

Concerning this, it is said:

Always cultivate an even mind toward sentient beings.

Lead them to authentically take up the supreme vehicle of the buddhas.

Teach the Dharma praised by the Victors.

Toward all sentient beings, maintain a joyful mind.

Engage rightly and abide in diligence.

Practice equally toward all sentient beings.

These four qualities are highly praised by the Victors —
the children of the Victors should always rely on them.

Kāśyapa, these four are the bad spiritual friends and bad companions of a bodhisattva, and a bodhisattva should entirely abandon them. What are the four? They are as follows: one who has entered upon the path for the benefit of śrāvakas; a pratyekabuddha who does little and acts little; a childish worldly person who is adept at reciting various secret words and who argues; and one

in association with whom all worldly material goods are gathered but the Dharma is never accumulated. Kāśyapa, these four are the bad spiritual friends and bad companions of a bodhisattva, and a bodhisattva should entirely abandon them.

Concerning this, it is said:

Those śrāvakas who strive for their own benefit,
and those who have gone forth and practice the yoga of solitary endeavor;
those pratyekabuddhas who do little and act little,
and who abandon all activity for the sake of their own welfare;
those childish ones who recite worldly proclamations
and argue against the teachings as they are given;
and those in whose company all material things are gathered
yet the Dharma is never accumulated —

Having thoroughly abandoned these four, a bodhisattva
should rely upon four virtuous spiritual friends.

These have been declared by the Victor to be bad friends and bad companions

—

keep far from them and abandon them entirely.

Kāśyapa, these four are the virtuous spiritual friends of a bodhisattva. What are the four? They are as follows: one who encourages reliance on the path to awakening is a virtuous spiritual friend of a bodhisattva; one who teaches the Dharma in order to support the wisdom born of hearing is a virtuous spiritual friend of a bodhisattva;

one who leads another into proper acceptance of the going-forth for the sake of relying upon all wholesome roots is a virtuous spiritual friend of a bodhisattva; and the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, are virtuous spiritual friends of a bodhisattva, for the sake of relying upon all the qualities of a buddha. Kāśyapa, these four are the virtuous spiritual friends of a bodhisattva.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Those who take up the path for the sake of relying fully on awakening
are virtuous spiritual friends of those who give.

One who speaks the Dharma's meaning produces hearing and wisdom —
the Sugata has declared such a one to be a virtuous spiritual friend.

Those who lead another into proper acceptance of the going-forth
are called spiritual friends because they are the root of virtue.

Since they are the path of the perfectly awakened ones to rely upon,
the buddhas are spiritual friends of the children of the Sugata.

These four praised by the Victor

are virtuous spiritual friends of the children of the Sugata.

If one relies upon them and is always heedful,

one will attain the awakening of the Sugata's teaching.

Kāśyapa, these four are the artificial conduct of a bodhisattva. What are the four? They are as follows: seeking gain and honor but not seeking the Dharma; seeking the beauty of eloquent words and verses but not seeking genuine qualities; always seeking one's own comfort but not seeking to remove the suffering of sentient beings; and seeking an entourage and assembly but not seeking solitude. Kāśyapa, these four are the artificial conduct of a bodhisattva.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Seeking gain, not desiring the Dharma;

seeking eloquence, not seeking genuine qualities;

always pursuing one's own comfort

while not seeking to remove the suffering of sentient beings;

seeking a crowd of followers, not wishing for solitude —

attached to ease, unattached to real qualities:

these four have been declared to be artificial conduct,

and a bodhisattva should abandon them entirely.

Kāśyapa, these four are the genuine qualities of a bodhisattva. What are the four? They are as follows: being devoted to emptiness and yet trusting in the karmic maturation of actions; accepting selflessness and yet having great compassion toward all sentient beings; in intention always dwelling in nirvāṇa, yet in practice remaining in saṃsāra; and giving generously in order to bring sentient beings to full maturation, while placing no hope in karmic maturation. Kāśyapa, these four are the genuine qualities of a bodhisattva.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Always devoted to phenomena as emptiness,

yet trusting in the karmic maturation of actions.

Accepting selflessness and resting in equanimity,

yet generating great compassion toward all sentient beings.

In intention, always dwelling in nirvāṇa,

yet in practice remaining in saṃsāra.

Giving generously in order to bring beings to full maturation,
yet placing no hope in karmic maturation.

Kāśyapa, these four are the great treasures found by a bodhisattva. What are the four? They are as follows: gladdening the buddhas wherever they arise; listening to the six perfections; looking upon those who teach the Dharma with a mind free from anger; and taking delight in dwelling in solitude with heedfulness. Kāśyapa, these four are the great treasures found by a bodhisattva.

Concerning this, the following is said:

In every life, one gladdens the buddhas,
and also listens to the six perfections.

Toward those who teach the Dharma one's mind is wholly serene,
and whenever one sees them, one always gives rise to reverence.
Always becoming heedful, one dwells in solitude,
and in that very suchness one always takes delight.

These four are proclaimed by the Sugata
to be the great treasures of the Victor's children.

Kāśyapa, these four are the qualities by which a bodhisattva rightly passes beyond the path of Māra. What are the four? They are as follows: not abandoning the awakening mind; holding no mind of anger toward any sentient being; examining all that has arisen as views; and not despising any sentient being. Kāśyapa, these four are the qualities by which a bodhisattva rightly passes beyond the path of Māra.

Concerning this, the following is said:

One never abandons the awakening mind,
and always relinquishes anger toward sentient beings.

One casts aside all that has arisen as views,
and never comes to despise the multitude of sentient beings.

The Sugata has proclaimed these four
to be the qualities by which one passes beyond Māra.

If one relies on them, one becomes a Victor, a perfect guide,
possessed of a body like gold, utterly unmatched.

Kāśyapa, these four are the qualities by which a bodhisattva gathers together all the roots of virtue. What are the four? They are as follows: dwelling in solitude without pretense or artifice; practicing the four means of gathering beings without expectation of any return; giving up body and life for the sake of all sentient beings while thoroughly seeking the sacred Dharma; and the diligence by which, never knowing satiation in learning and in meaning, one perfectly gathers together all roots of virtue. Kāśyapa, these four are the qualities by which a bodhisattva gathers together all the roots of virtue.

Concerning this, the following is said:

One dwells in solitude and fully abandons all pretense,
and practices toward sentient beings the means of gathering proclaimed by
the Victor.

Having undertaken the thorough seeking of the sacred Dharma,
one gives up even body and life.

The roots of virtue are utterly without limit,
and in striving to accomplish them rightly one never knows satiation.

In order to gather together all virtuous qualities,
the Sugata has proclaimed these four qualities.

Kāśyapa, these four are the bodhisattva's immeasurable accumulation of merit. What are the four? They are as follows: giving Dharma with a mind utterly free from miserliness; feeling great compassion toward those who have broken their moral discipline; revealing the awakening mind to all sentient beings; and cultivating patience toward those who are humble and lowly. Kāśyapa, these four are the bodhisattva's immeasurable accumulation of merit.

Concerning this, the following is said:

With a mind that is pure and utterly free from miserliness,
one gives the Dharma — and this the Victor has greatly praised.

Toward those who lack moral discipline one feels great compassion,
and leads others to arouse the mind aimed at awakening.

Toward those who are humble and lowly, one embraces them with patience.

This has been proclaimed to be the gathering of virtuous qualities.

Since relying on these leads one to become a Victor,
a bodhisattva should always rely on them.

Kāśyapa, these four are the qualities by which a bodhisattva destroys the afflictions that are the ground of the habitual tendencies of ignorance. What

are the four? They are as follows: properly upholding the vow of moral discipline; fully upholding the sacred Dharma; offering lamps; and giving even to those who are familiar acquaintances. Kāśyapa, these four are the qualities by which a bodhisattva destroys the afflictions that are the ground of the habitual tendencies of ignorance.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Properly upholding the vow of moral discipline,
upholding the sacred Dharma, and offering lamps,
as well as giving even to those who are merely familiar —
through these a wise one thoroughly clears away the ground of ignorance.

Kāśyapa, these four are the qualities by which a bodhisattva attains wisdom free from obscuration.

What are these four? They are: giving the sacred Dharma; upholding the sacred Dharma; being free from envy; and not despising others. Kāśyapa, these four are the qualities by which a bodhisattva attains wisdom free from obscuration.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Having abandoned the forty non-virtues
that obstruct awakening,
if a wise one then relies upon the other twelve,
touching the deathless, one will attain awakening.
Noble sentient beings who uphold, recite,
or rely earnestly upon this Dharma teaching —
the Victor has declared their merit to be boundless,
and the Victor alone could fully describe its measure.
One who fills as many fields as grains of sand in the Ganges
with jewels and offers them all to the Victor —
compared to one who reads even a four-line verse of this teaching,
no one could count the merit of the latter.

Kāśyapa, a bodhisattva should not be called a bodhisattva by name alone. Rather, one who is engaged in Dharma practice, in conduct that is harmonious and wholesome, and who is established in the Dharma — such a one is rightly called a bodhisattva.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, a bodhisattva who possesses thirty-two qualities is rightly called a bodhisattva. What are these thirty-two? They are as follows:

Having the superior intention to bring benefit and happiness to all sentient beings; entering into the gnosis of omniscience; gauging oneself honestly and not disparaging the understanding of others; being free from pride; having a steadfast superior intention; having loving-kindness that is uncontrived; having an even mind toward those who are dear and those who are not dear; being forever friendly toward all until the very end of nirvāṇa; speaking gently with fitting words and a smiling countenance; not being weary toward those who have taken up a burden; never severing great compassion toward all sentient beings; never becoming mentally despondent; listening in order to seek out the sacred Dharma; never being satisfied with meaning; regarding one's own faults as faults while not reproaching others for theirs; purifying the awakening mind in all forms of conduct; giving without hope for karmic maturation; moral discipline that does not settle into any birth within continued existence; patience free from resentment toward all sentient beings; diligence that accomplishes all wholesome roots fully and correctly; meditative concentration that illuminates the formless realm; wisdom held by skillful means and perfectly endowed with the four means of gathering disciples through skillful means; loving-kindness that is non-dual toward those who maintain moral discipline and those who have broken it; listening to the Dharma with reverence; delighting with reverence in dwelling in solitude; having no delight in the diverse things of the world and delighting in things that transcend the world; not desiring the Lesser Vehicle and viewing the Great Vehicle as beneficial; completely abandoning evil companions and relying on a spiritual friend (Skt. *kalyāṇamitra*); practicing the four divine abodes (Skt. *brahmavihāra*); excelling through the five higher knowledges (Skt. *abhijñā*); relying on wisdom; not abandoning sentient beings who are engaged in proper practice and in mistaken practice; speaking with singular resolve; cherishing truth; and having the awakening mind go before all else.

Kāśyapa, a bodhisattva who possesses these thirty-two qualities is rightly called a bodhisattva.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Aspiring with superior intention
to bring benefit and happiness to all beings,
freeing the mind toward the gnosis of omniscience —
gauge yourself as if you were a mountain or a human hill.
Free from disparagement and from excessive pride,
with steadfast intention and loving-kindness uncontrived —

with an even mind toward both the dear and the unloved,
utterly devoted to sentient beings until the very shore of nirvāṇa,
always showing the greatest love to all beings,
speaking gently with a smiling face;
not growing weary or despondent under the burden taken up,
never severing compassion toward sentient beings entirely,
not growing disheartened in seeking the holy Dharma,
looking upon one's own faults and errors as insatiable as one's hearing is of
teaching,
not scorching others with harsh reproach,
refining the mind thoroughly in every kind of conduct,
harboring no hope for the ripening of what is given,
not dwelling in moral discipline for the sake of continued existence in saṃsāra,
being patient with sentient beings and free from anger,
diligence in the proper accomplishment of virtue,
meditative concentration that has abandoned the formless realm,
wisdom properly seized by means of skillful means,
the means of properly gathering beings through the four ways of gathering,
loving-kindness that makes no distinction between those with discipline and
those without,
reverently listening to the Dharma at the proper time,
dwelling in reverently maintained solitude and calm,
taking no delight in the manifold things of the world,
taking no delight in the lesser vehicle (Hīnayāna),
generating aspiration for the Great Vehicle (Mahāyāna),
completely abandoning evil companions,
always relying upon virtuous spiritual friends,
meditating on the four divine abodes (brahmavihāras),
constantly endeavoring through the five kinds of direct knowledge (abhiññās),
always following in the wake of primordial wisdom,
not abandoning those who possess accomplishment,
likewise not abandoning others who lack accomplishment,
always speaking with singular resolve,
always acting with reverence toward truth,
and, with the awakening mind having gone before all else,
cultivating the qualities praised by the Victors.

These thirty-two qualities spoken by the Sugata
are to be relied upon by the sons of the Sugata.
Those bodhisattvas, the Sugata has declared,
are ones who possess these qualities.

Kāśyapa, I shall now teach you analogies that illuminate a thorough understanding of the bodhisattva's qualities. Kāśyapa, consider, for example, this great earth: it is the sustenance of all sentient beings, unchanging, and harboring no hope for recompense. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, a bodhisattva who first gives rise to the awakening mind remains, until reaching the heart of awakening, the sustenance of all sentient beings, unchanging and harboring no hope for recompense. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as this earth is the sustenance of all people,
expecting no return, unchanged and firm,
so the bodhisattva, with mind first settled thus,
until becoming a supreme Victor, a peerless buddha,
is the sustenance of all people,
expecting no return and without change.
With mind equal toward both son and enemy alike,
seeking without cease the supreme and perfect awakening.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, the element of water: it brings forth all roots, creepers, medicinal plants, and forests. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, a bodhisattva with a purified intention, abiding with loving-kindness pervading all sentient beings, brings forth all wholesome qualities in all sentient beings. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as water brings forth grasses, creepers,
forests, medicinal plants, and every kind of grain,
so the bodhisattva with purified intention
pervades countless sentient beings with loving-kindness,
spreads through the manifold qualities in gradual progression,
flourishes fully through the wholesome qualities,
defeats Māra together with his hosts and armies,
and gradually attains the awakening of the Victors.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, the element of fire: it brings all crops to full ripening. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, the wisdom of the bodhisattva brings all the wholesome qualities of all sentient beings to full ripening. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as fire fully ripens grasses and medicinal plants —
fully ripens all crops.

Just so, the wisdom of the Sugata's son
ripens the wholesome qualities of all people.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, the element of wind: it accomplishes all the buddha-fields. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, the skillful means of the bodhisattva also accomplishes all the qualities of the buddhas for all sentient beings. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as the wind, in accordance with the buddhas' intention,
accomplishes the manifold fields in all their variety,
so too the skillful means of the Victors' sons
accomplishes the supreme Dharma proclaimed by the Sugatas.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, the fourfold army of the hosts of the sinful Māra: it is unable to overwhelm or utterly exhaust all the gods of the desire realm. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, the pure intention of a bodhisattva is also something that all the māras are unable to overwhelm or utterly exhaust.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how during the waxing phase of the moon the lunar disc grows and becomes full. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, the bodhisattva of pure intention also grows and becomes vast through all wholesome qualities. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as the lunar disc during the waxing phase
grows and becomes full, and does not wane,
so too the bodhisattva of pure intention
always grows ever vaster through wholesome qualities.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how the rays of light that issue all at once from the solar disc illuminate all sentient beings. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, the rays of wisdom that issue all at once from the bodhisattvas also bring the light of knowing to all sentient beings. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as the rays that issue all at once from the sun
illuminate all sentient beings,
so too the rays of the Victors' sons' primordial wisdom
bring the light of wisdom to all sentient beings.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how the lion, king of beasts, goes wherever it pleases without fear or dread. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, the bodhisattva

who abides in learning, moral discipline, training, the qualities of cultivation, good provisions, meditative absorption, and primordial wisdom also goes wherever it pleases without fear or dread. Concerning this, the following is said:

The lion, king of beasts, with its flowing mane,
goes wherever it wishes, utterly without fear.
Just so, the bodhisattva grounded in moral discipline,
in learning and in wisdom, goes with joy and ease.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how a well-tamed and mighty elephant carries every burden without growing weary at all. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, the bodhisattva whose mind is thoroughly tamed also carries the burden of the five aggregates for the sake of all sentient beings without growing weary at all. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as a well-tamed and powerful elephant
carries its burdens without growing weary,
so too the bodhisattva of thoroughly tamed mind
is never wearied by the burden of sentient beings.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how the lotus, though born from water, is not stained by the water. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, the bodhisattva, though born into the world, is not stained by worldly phenomena. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as the lotus, though born from water,
is not stained by the water or the mud,
so too the bodhisattva, born into the world,
is never stained by any worldly phenomenon.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how a tree whose branches have been cut will sprout again from the ground if its roots have not been severed.

Kāśyapa, in just the same way, the bodhisattva who is skilled in skillful means — though the branches of affliction have been cut — if the engagement with the roots of virtue through great compassion remains unimpaired, is reborn again in the three realms. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as a tree whose branches have been cut
will sprout again if its firm roots are left intact,
so too, if the engagement with roots is not abandoned,
though removed by skillful means, one is reborn once more.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how the great masses of water flowing from rivers coming from many different directions all pour into the great ocean and become one in the single taste of salt. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, all the roots of virtue accumulated by a bodhisattva through many different doors, when fully dedicated to awakening, likewise become one in the single taste of omniscience. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as rivers flowing from many different directions
pour into the great ocean and become one in taste,
so too all virtue accumulated through many different doors
and dedicated to awakening becomes one in taste.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how the gods of the Four Great Kings and the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three dwell upon Mount Meru. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, the bodhisattva's omniscience also dwells upon the roots of virtue of the awakening mind. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as the hosts of gods of the Four Great Kings
and the Thirty-Three dwell upon Mount Meru,
so too the bodhisattva, dwelling in virtue,
attains omniscience and then teaches the Dharma.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how kings who are supported by ministers perform all royal activities. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, wisdom that is supported by skillful means performs all the deeds of a buddha. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as kings who are attended by ministers
always perform all royal activities,
so too the wisdom of a bodhisattva possessed of skillful means
always performs all the purposes of a buddha.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how in a cloudless, clear, open sky there is no cause for rain to fall. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, for a bodhisattva of little learning there is no cause for the rain of the sacred Dharma to fall. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as in a cloudless, clear, open sky
no cause for rain to fall is ever to be found,
so too for a bodhisattva of little learning
it will never be found that they teach the Dharma.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how the continuous stream of rain arising from a great cloud falls visibly upon all crops. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, the rain of the sacred Dharma arising from the great Dharma cloud of a bodhisattva's great compassion and vast learning also falls visibly upon all sentient beings. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as rain falling from a great cloud with lightning
abundantly satisfies all crops,
so too the stream of Dharma arising from the cloud
of a bodhisattva's sacred Dharma satisfies all sentient beings.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how wherever a wheel-turning king (cakravartin) is born, the seven precious treasures also appear there. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, wherever a bodhisattva is born, the thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening also appear there. Concerning this, the following is said:

Wherever a wheel-turning king is born,
his seven precious treasures appear there.
Wherever a bodhisattva takes birth,
the seven branches of his awakening appear there.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how wherever a precious lapis-lazuli gem appears, there too many hundreds and thousands of kārṣāpaṇa coins appear. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, wherever a bodhisattva appears, there too many hundreds of thousands of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas appear. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as wherever a precious gem appears,
many kārṣāpaṇas arise there too,
so wherever the mind of perfect awakening appears,
many śrāvakas arise there as well.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how those who dwell in the Nandana Grove of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three are equal in the enjoyments they possess and use. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, a bodhisattva who is engaged with a pure intention becomes equal in all activities toward all sentient beings. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as the enjoyments of the gods
dwelling in the Nandana Grove are equal,
so too a bodhisattva of pure intention

always engages beneficially toward all sentient beings.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how poison that has been fully secured by mantra and medicine cannot cause death. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, a bodhisattva who is fully secured by wisdom and skillful means cannot be caused to fall into error by the poison of the afflictions. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as poison fully secured by mantra
cannot harm people,
so too a bodhisattva endowed with wisdom
cannot be caused to fall by the afflictions.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how the waste and sewage of great cities becomes beneficial to fields of sugarcane and to vineyards. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, whatever is the afflictive waste of a bodhisattva also becomes beneficial to omniscience itself. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as the impure sewage of cities
is beneficial to fields of sugarcane,
so too the afflictive waste of a bodhisattva
becomes beneficial to the Dharma of the Victors.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how one learns the art of weaponry from a teacher who has not yet mastered the bow. In just the same way, one should look upon a bodhisattva's thorough discernment, analysis, and knowledge that grasps the meaning of the sacred Dharma even from limited learning.

Kāśyapa, consider, for example, how a potter must apply great fire to vessels that have not yet been fired with unfermented clay. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, a bodhisattva must apply the great fire of the Buddha's Dharma to sentient beings whose wisdom is not yet ripe.

Kāśyapa, therefore, a bodhisattva who wishes to train in this great Dharma compendium of the Mahāratnakūṭa should apply himself properly and thoroughly to the Dharma. And what, Kāśyapa, is a bodhisattva's thorough and proper application to the Dharma? It is this: the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way. And what, Kāśyapa, is the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way? Kāśyapa, it is the individual discernment of no-self, the absence of a sentient being, the absence of a life-force, the absence of a nourishing soul, the

absence of a person, the absence of an individual, the absence of one born from seed, and the absence of a son of seed. Kāśyapa, this is called the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way.

Furthermore, Kāśyapa, the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way is this: not discerning form as permanent, and not discerning it as impermanent either. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, not discerning feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness as permanent, and not discerning them as impermanent either.

Kāśyapa, this is called the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way.

Furthermore, Kāśyapa, the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way is this: not discerning the earth element as permanent, and not discerning it as impermanent either. In just the same way, not discerning the water element, the fire element, the wind element, the space element, or the consciousness element as permanent, and not discerning them as impermanent either. Kāśyapa, this is called the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way.

Furthermore, Kāśyapa, the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way is this: not discerning the sense base of the eye as permanent, and not discerning it as impermanent either. In just the same way, not discerning the sense bases of the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, and the mind as permanent, and not discerning them as impermanent either. Kāśyapa, this is called the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way.

Kāśyapa, what is called "permanent" is one extreme. What is called "impermanent" is the second extreme. The middle between those two extremes is something that cannot be examined, cannot be indicated, is without support, without appearance, without distinct cognition, and without location. Kāśyapa, this is called the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way.

Kāśyapa, what is called "self" is one extreme. What is called "selflessness" is the second extreme. The middle between those two extremes is something that cannot be examined, cannot be indicated, is without support, without appearance, without distinct cognition, and without location. Kāśyapa, this is called the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way.

Kāśyapa, what is called "mind is pure" is one extreme. What is called "mind is not pure" is the second extreme. Kāśyapa, that in which there is no mind, no thinking, no mentation, and no consciousness — this, Kāśyapa, is called the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way.

And it is the same for virtuous and non-virtuous phenomena, for worldly and transcendent phenomena, for blameworthy and blameless phenomena, for defiled and undefiled phenomena, and for all conditioned and unconditioned phenomena alike.

Kāśyapa, what is called "total affliction" is one extreme. What is called "complete purification" is the second extreme. That which neither asserts, nor speaks, nor proclaims those two extremes — this, Kāśyapa, is called the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way.

Kāśyapa, what is called "existence" is one extreme. What is called "non-existence" is the second extreme. The middle between those two is something that cannot be examined, cannot be indicated, is without support, without appearance, without distinct cognition, and without location. Kāśyapa, this is called the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way.

Kāśyapa, what is called "saṃsāra" is one extreme. What is called "nirvāṇa" is the second extreme. The middle between those two is something that cannot be examined, cannot be indicated, is without support, without appearance, without distinct cognition, and without location. Kāśyapa, this is called the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way.

Kāśyapa, I have further taught you that conditioned by ignorance arise formations; conditioned by formations arises consciousness; conditioned by consciousness arise name and form; conditioned by name and form arise the six sense bases; conditioned by the six sense bases arises contact;

conditioned by contact arises feeling; conditioned by feeling arises craving; conditioned by craving arises grasping; conditioned by grasping arises becoming; conditioned by becoming arises birth; conditioned by birth arise aging and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, mental anguish, and distress. In this way there arises this single great mass of suffering alone.

When ignorance ceases, formations cease. When formations cease, consciousness ceases. When consciousness ceases, name and form cease. When name and form cease, the six sense bases cease. When the six sense

bases cease, contact ceases. When contact ceases, feeling ceases. When feeling ceases, craving ceases. When craving ceases, grasping ceases. When grasping ceases, becoming ceases. When becoming ceases, birth ceases. When birth ceases, aging and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, mental anguish, and distress cease. In this way there ceases this single great mass of suffering alone.

With respect to this teaching, Kāśyapa, awareness and ignorance are not two, and they are inseparable as two aspects. Whatever discernment there is in this, Kāśyapa, is called the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way.

Likewise, formations and the unconditioned; consciousness and the cessation of consciousness; name and form and the cessation of name and form; the six sense bases and the cessation of the six sense bases; contact and the cessation of contact; feeling and the cessation of feeling; craving and the cessation of craving; grasping and the cessation of grasping; becoming and the cessation of becoming; birth and the cessation of birth; aging and death and the cessation of aging and death — all of these are not two, and they are inseparable as two aspects. Whatever discernment there is in this, Kāśyapa, is called the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way.

Furthermore, Kāśyapa, the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way is this: it is not that emptiness makes phenomena empty — phenomena are themselves empty. It is not that signlessness makes phenomena signless — phenomena are themselves signless. It is not that wishlessness makes phenomena wishless — phenomena are themselves wishless. It is not that non-construction makes phenomena non-constructed — phenomena are themselves non-constructed. It is not that non-arising makes phenomena unarisen — phenomena are themselves unarisen. It is not that non-occurrence makes phenomena non-occurred — phenomena are themselves non-occurred. It is not that essencelessness makes phenomena essenceless — phenomena are themselves essenceless. Whoever discerns things in this way, Kāśyapa, is said to have the correct and individual discernment of the phenomena of the Middle Way.

Moreover, Kāśyapa, emptiness is not for the purpose of destroying the person — emptiness itself is empty. Kāśyapa, the past extreme is empty, the future extreme is empty, and what arises in the present is empty. One should rely on

emptiness itself, and not on any person. Kāśyapa, those who, perceiving persons as emptiness, rely on emptiness — I have declared that such persons have gone utterly astray from this scripture.

Kāśyapa, it is easier to hold a view of a self as large as Mount Meru than to hold a view of emptiness with conceit. Why is that? Kāśyapa, emptiness is the remedy for all views that have arisen; but one who clings to emptiness alone — I have declared that such a person cannot be cured.

Kāśyapa, consider this:

Suppose there is a sick person, and a physician administers a purgative medicine to him. That medicine moves all his illness, but if the medicine then fails to be expelled from his belly — Kāśyapa, what do you think? Will that person be freed from his illness?

Kāśyapa replied: Blessed One, he will not. If the medicine has moved all the illness but does not itself come out of the belly, that person's condition will become extremely grave.

The Blessed One declared: Kāśyapa, in just the same way, emptiness is what arises as the supreme remedy for all views that have taken hold. But Kāśyapa, one who holds a view of emptiness alone — I have declared that such a person cannot be cured.

And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as a physician, wishing to clear a person's illness,
administers a purgative,
yet if the illness moves but the purge is not expelled,
the person will not recover from that condition —
so too, from views lying densely settled within,
emptiness is the supreme thing that arises;
yet one who holds a view of emptiness alone —
the Victor has declared that such a person cannot be cured.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: suppose a certain person, terrified of the sky, beats his chest and weeps, crying out, "Remove this sky! Remove this sky!" Kāśyapa, what do you think? Can that sky be removed?

Kāśyapa replied: Blessed One, that is not possible.

The Blessed One declared: Kāśyapa, in just the same way, whatever śramaṇas (renunciants) and brahmins are frightened by emptiness, are utterly terrified

— I have declared that those people fall into great mental disturbance. Why is that? Kāśyapa, it is because they engage with emptiness and yet are frightened by that very emptiness.

And concerning this, the following is said:

Like a foolish person threatened by fear of the sky
who cries out, "Remove this sky!" —
though the sky cannot be removed,
childish, bewildered ones speak in just that way —
so too, whatever śramaṇas and brahmins
are frightened by emptiness, their minds disturbed,
those childish ones, who engage with emptiness,
cannot destroy emptiness anywhere at all.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: suppose a painter paints his own terrifying image of a yakṣa, and then, terrified by it, falls in a faint and loses consciousness. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, childish ordinary persons, though they wander in saṃsāra through forms, sounds, smells, tastes, and tangibles of their own making, do not truly understand those phenomena for what they actually are.

And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as a painter, having made
a terrifying image of a yakṣa,
is frightened by it, falls in a faint,
and loses consciousness —
so all childish ordinary persons,
bewildered by form, sound, and the rest
of their own making,
go wandering through the six classes of beings.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: suppose a magician conjures an illusion, and that very illusion then devours the magician himself. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, whatever a yogin monk (Skt. yogācāra bhikṣu) brings to mind — all of that appears to him as a heap, as a husk, as something utterly without essence.

And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as an illusion conjured and made manifest by a magician
devours that very magician —

whatever the yogin brings to mind
appears to him as a heap and a husk.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: suppose two sticks are rubbed together by the wind, and fire arises from them, and having arisen, burns both those sticks. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, when genuine discernment is present, the noble faculty of wisdom arises, and having arisen, burns up that very discernment itself.

And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as from two sticks rubbed together by the wind
fire arises, and having arisen, burns those very sticks —
so too, when the faculty of wisdom arises,
it burns up that very discernment itself.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: when a lamp is lit, all the darkness and deep gloom vanishes entirely — yet that darkness and deep gloom does not go anywhere, nor does it come from anywhere. It does not depart to the east, the south, the west, or the north. And yet, Kāśyapa, that lamp does not think to itself, "I have dispelled the darkness and deep gloom" — and nonetheless, in dependence upon the lamp, the darkness and deep gloom cease to be.

Kāśyapa, with regard to this, both the lamp and the darkness and deep gloom are equally empty — they are ungrasped and without agency.

In just the same way, Kāśyapa, when gnosis arises, ignorance ceases to be — yet that ignorance does not go anywhere, nor does it come from anywhere. It does not depart to the east, the south, the west, or the north. And gnosis, too, does not think to itself, "I have dispelled ignorance" — and nonetheless, in dependence upon gnosis, ignorance ceases to be.

Kāśyapa, with regard to this, both gnosis and ignorance are equally empty — they are ungrasped and without agency.

And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as a lamp causes all darkness and deep gloom
to cease to be, yet that darkness comes from nowhere and goes nowhere —
so too, when gnosis arises and ignorance is no more,
from where does it come, and to where does it go?

The lamp does not think, "I have dispelled the darkness" —
yet when light appears, darkness ceases to be.
Empty, ungrasped, like a flower in the sky —
so too, gnosis and ignorance are both empty.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: suppose a house, a hall, or a small room has not had a lamp lit in it for a hundred thousand years, and then someone lights a lamp there. Kāśyapa, what do you think — would that darkness and deep gloom think to itself, "I have been accumulating here for a hundred thousand years, I shall not depart from this place"?

Kāśyapa replied: Blessed One, it would not think thus. The moment a lamp is lit, the darkness and deep gloom has no power to resist vanishing — it will without any doubt cease to be.

The Blessed One declared: Kāśyapa, in just the same way, karma and mental afflictions accumulated over a hundred thousand aeons will be eliminated by a single moment of discernment that is attended to in the proper way.

Kāśyapa, the word "lamp" is a metaphor for the noble faculty of wisdom. Kāśyapa, the words "darkness and deep gloom" are a metaphor for the karma and mental afflictions of one who is not noble.

And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as when someone in a house, after a long time,
lights a lamp —
the darkness does not think, "I have dwelt here long,
I shall not depart from this place."

Once the lamp is kindled, the darkness and deep gloom
has no power to remain without vanishing —
in dependence upon the lamp, darkness ceases to be.
Both are empty; there is not the slightest conceit in either.

In just the same way, in dependence upon the undefiled noble gnosis,
ignorance and accumulated afflictions cease to be.
Gnosis and affliction have never, not even for a moment,
kept company with each other even once.

Gnosis does not think, "I shall cause ignorance to cease" —
yet in dependence upon gnosis, ignorance ceases to be.
Both are ungrasped, like a flower in the sky —
so too, gnosis and ignorance are both empty.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: seeds do not grow in the sky. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, the buddha-qualities of a bodhisattva do not arise from the unconditioned — they have not arisen and will not arise from it.

And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as seeds cannot sprout from the sky —

In past, future, and present there are none —

just so, from the unconditioned, the buddha-qualities
have never arisen and will never arise.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: just as every seed grows from fertile, moisture-rich soil, so too, Kāśyapa, the buddha-qualities of a bodhisattva arise from a world that abides soaked through with the moisture of affliction. And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as seeds grow in soil that holds moisture and is damp,
and not in arid and barren wastelands —

so too, in beings who are afflicted and turned the wrong way,
the qualities of the Victor arise in the sons of the Victor.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: just as lotus flowers do not grow in arid wilderness and barren wastelands, so too, Kāśyapa, the buddha-qualities of a bodhisattva have not arisen and will not arise from the unconditioned. And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as lotuses grow in ponds and lakes

and never arise in arid wastelands —

so too, the qualities of the Victor

never have arisen and never will arise from the unconditioned.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: just as lotus flowers grow from muddy water that contains moisture, so too, Kāśyapa, the buddha-qualities of a bodhisattva arise in those sentient beings who are mired in the muddy water of affliction and are definitively turned the wrong way. And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as lotuses grow from muddy water rich with moisture

and never from dry upland ground —

so too, in beings who are afflicted and turned the wrong way,
the qualities of the Victor arise in the sons of the Victor.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: one should look upon the accumulation of roots of virtue consciously gathered by a bodhisattva as being like the four great oceans filled entirely with butter and cream. And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as the four oceans, filled with butter and cream,
are pure and utterly pleasing on every side —
so too, regard the bodhisattva, the son of the Sugata,
as always filled with the wind of virtue.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: it is just as if a person were to take up a single drop of water from the four great oceans using the tip of a hair split into a hundred strands — in that same way, Kāśyapa, one should regard the accumulation of roots of virtue consciously gathered by the śrāvakas. And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as from that great mass of water
one lifts a drop upon the tip of a hundredfold-split hair —
so too regard the virtue accumulated by the śrāvakas
as a thing possessed of such virtue.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: one should regard the śrāvakas' knowledge of the unconditioned as being like the space inside a mustard seed that has been eaten out by a worm. And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as the inner space of a mustard seed eaten by a worm
is small —
so too regard the śrāvaka's knowledge of the unconditioned
as small, exceedingly small.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: one should regard the bodhisattva's knowledge of the unconditioned as being like the realm of space in all ten directions. And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as throughout all the worlds in the ten directions
the realm of space abides without obstruction —
so too regard the bodhisattva's knowledge of the unconditioned,
the supreme of all beings, as being just like that.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: suppose a noble queen, consecrated from the crown by a king of royal lineage, were to lie with a poor man, and a child were later born to her from that union. Kāśyapa, what do you think — would that child be called the king's son? He replied: Blessed One, it would not be so. The

Blessed One declared: Just so, Kāśyapa, though my śrāvakas are born from the dharmadhātu, they are not to be called worthy of the consecration as sons of the Tathāgata. And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as a king's queen, pleasing to behold —

has lain with a poor man —

the child born thereafter from that union

is not the king's son and not fit for consecration.

Just so, śrāvakas who have become free from attachment

are not worthy to be called my sons fit for consecration.

Yet those who strive for my benefit in this way,

acting for the good of both self and others — these are sons of the buddhas.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: suppose a wheel-turning king, consecrated from the crown by lineage, were to lie with a wicked maidservant, and a child were later born from that union. Kāśyapa, though that child has come from a wicked maidservant, he would still be called the king's son. Kāśyapa, just so, a bodhisattva who has first aroused the awakening mind, though he still wanders in saṃsāra and has not yet attained the power to tame sentient beings, is still to be called a son of the Tathāgata. And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as the child born to a wheel-turning king

from his lying with a maidservant —

though born of a maidservant,

the world yet calls him the king's son —

so too a bodhisattva who has first aroused the awakening mind,

wandering through the three realms of existence with little power,

unable yet to tame sentient beings through generosity and skillful means,

is called a son of the Victor by all pure sentient beings.

This is the end of the second fascicle.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: suppose a wheel-turning king had a thousand young sons, strong and possessed of swift momentum and power, yet none of them bore the marks of a wheel-turning king. Just as no one would form the perception that these are sons of a wheel-turning king, because they lack the capacity to carry out his noble tasks — just so, Kāśyapa, if among the tens of millions of śrāvakas who attend at the feet of the Tathāgata not a single one has become a bodhisattva, then no one forms the perception that these are sons of the Tathāgata. And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as a king of men might have a thousand sons
yet none bears the marks of a son,
and so they cannot be cherished as such
and no one holds the perception of them as the supreme man's sons —
just so, though there be many millions who attend at the feet of the buddhas,
if not one among them is a bodhisattva,
then because no bodhisattva is to be found among them,
the Sugata does not regard them as his sons.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: suppose that within the noble womb of a wheel-turning king's queen, a young one bearing the marks of a wheel-turning king had been conceived and had reached seven days of gestation — though he dwells still in the undifferentiated state of the great elements, he is already supremely powerful, and therefore the gods place their hopes in him. This is not the case with the thousand young sons who are strong, possess swift momentum, and have attained power. Why is that? Because the line of the wheel-turning king continues unbroken through this one. Kāśyapa, just so, a bodhisattva who has first aroused the awakening mind — whose faculties are not yet fully ripened, who dwells still in the undifferentiated state of the great elements of the afflictions, who wanders in saṃsāra while perfectly accomplishing the qualities of buddhahood — because he is supremely powerful, the gods who have previously seen buddhas place their hopes in him. This is not the case with the arhats who dwell in meditative concentration through the eight liberations. Why is that? Because the lineage of the buddhas continues unbroken through this bodhisattva. And concerning this, the following is said:

Just as when the supreme queen of the wheel-turning king
has conceived in her womb a being bearing the marks of merit —
because of his power the gods place their hopes in him,
but not in those young ones who have attained power —
so too a bodhisattva who dwells with one-pointed mind,
remaining in saṃsāra and seeking awakening:
in him the gods and nāgas place their hopes,
but not in those who meditate through the eight liberations.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: a single precious gem of beryl (vaidūrya)
utterly outshines a heap of ordinary gems as vast as Mount Meru.

Kāśyapa, in the same way, even a bodhisattva who has first given rise to the awakening mind outshines all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as the luminous precious gem of beryl
outshines a heap of ordinary gems —
so too a bodhisattva who has first given rise to the awakening mind
outshines even a thousand śrāvakas in just that way.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: a young cuckoo (kalapiṅka) chick still dwelling in the shell of its egg — though its eyes are not yet open — outshines the entire assembly of birds with its voice, deep and melodious. Kāśyapa, in the same way, a bodhisattva who has first given rise to the awakening mind, though still dwelling within the shell of the egg of ignorance, with eyes covered by the darkness of karma and affliction and the film of cataracts — even so, with the voice of the practice of fully dedicating wholesome roots, outshines all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: when the noble queen of a wheel-turning king gives birth to a young prince bearing the marks of a wheel-turning king, immediately upon his birth all the merchants, townspeople, all the people of the realm, and all the lesser kings bow down to him. Kāśyapa, in the same way, the world together with its gods bows down to a bodhisattva who has first given rise to the awakening mind. Concerning this, the following is said:

If a great lord of the earth, a king,
should have a son whose body is adorned with marks —
the very moment that young prince is seen to be born,
all the people of the city and all the lesser kings bow down.
Likewise, the very moment the awakening mind is given rise to,
to that son of the Victors bearing the marks,
the world together with its gods bows down
and holds him utterly dear with hearts of pure faith.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: all the medicinal plants that grow on the king of mountains, the Snowy Mountain (Himālaya), have no pride, no partiality, no conceptual thought — and whichever illness they are applied to, they bring that illness to utter pacification. Kāśyapa, in the same way, all the medicine of wisdom (jñāna) that a bodhisattva cultivates is cultivated without conceptual thought, and is applied to heal all sentient beings with a mind of equanimity. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as on the king of mountains, the snow mountain,
the medicinal plants that grow there have no conceptuality, no pride —
whatever they are applied to, they bring all to peace,
and some even dispel illness and old age —
so too, the son of the Victors, cultivating the medicine of wisdom,
cultivates all things free from conceptual thought,
and does so entirely for the benefit of sentient beings,
healing them with a mind of equanimity.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: just as all bow down to the new moon, but not to the full moon in the same way — Kāśyapa, in the same way, those who have sincere faith in me should bow down to the bodhisattvas, and not to the Tathāgatas in the same manner. Why is that? Because it is from bodhisattvas that the Tathāgatas arise, and from the Tathāgatas that all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas arise. Concerning this, the following is said:

All bow down to the new moon,
yet they do not bow to the full moon in the same way.
Likewise, those who have faith in me
should pay homage to the sons of the Victors, the bodhisattvas.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: just as the letters of the alphabet are what precede and make possible the mastery of all treatises — Kāśyapa, in the same way, a bodhisattva who has first given rise to the awakening mind is what precedes and makes possible the unsurpassed wisdom that holds all of a buddha's emanations and all of his blessings. Kāśyapa, consider this further:

Consider this further, Kāśyapa: just as no one has ever paid homage first to the images of the stars while setting aside the disc of the moon, in the same way the wise, setting aside the bodhisattvas who have entered into my training with great compassion that benefits both themselves and others, have never paid homage to śrāvakas. Concerning this, the following is said:

Whoever sets the moon aside
and pays homage to the host of stars instead —
in the same way, those who have entered the training
set aside my sons and do not bow to śrāvakas.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: even if the world with its gods were to polish a piece of glass, that glass would never become a precious lapis lazuli gem. Kāśyapa, in the same way, even if a śrāvaka were possessed of moral discipline, training, purified qualities, restrained conduct, every form of

meditative absorption, and were seated at the seat of awakening, he would never fully awaken to unsurpassed and perfect enlightenment. Concerning this, the following is said:

Even if the world with all its gods were to polish
a piece of glass with all their might,
glass remains glass — it cannot become lapis lazuli:
such is its very nature, its intrinsic reality.

Likewise, a śrāvaka possessed of moral discipline,
of learning, of meditative concentration, and of all refinement,
though seated at the seat of awakening and having tamed Māra,
cannot touch awakening and become a Sugata — it cannot be.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: if a precious lapis lazuli gem is polished, it becomes the source from which many hundreds and thousands of gold coins flow. Kāśyapa, in the same way, if the qualities of a bodhisattva are refined and cultivated, that becomes the source from which many hundreds and thousands of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas flow. Concerning this, the following is said:

When a precious lapis lazuli gem is polished,
many gold coins flow forth from it.

Likewise, when a son of the buddhas refines and cultivates his qualities,
it becomes the source from which many śrāvakas flow.

Then the Blessed One again declared to the venerable Mahākāśyapa: Kāśyapa, in whatever land a black-headed insect known as the cricket lies sprawled on its back, that land becomes filled with fear, injury, nearby afflictions, and strife. Kāśyapa, if a bodhisattva were to appear in that same land, it would become free of fear, free of injury, free of nearby afflictions, and free of strife. Therefore, Kāśyapa, a bodhisattva should strive for the benefit of sentient beings, and in doing so should perfectly accomplish all roots of virtue. Having perfectly accomplished all roots of virtue, he should dedicate them to all sentient beings. Seeking the medicine of primordial wisdom, he should go to the four directions and provide genuine healing to sentient beings. He should heal sentient beings with genuine healing.

Now, Kāśyapa, what is genuine healing? It is this: for attachment, the perception of the unattractive; for aversion, loving-kindness; for delusion, dependent origination; for all views, emptiness; for all thinking, reflection, conceptual thought, and mental engagement directed toward signs and

objects as characteristics, the signless; and in order to abandon all abiding in the desire realm, the form realm, and the formless realm, the wishless; and the four non-inverted perceptions to abandon all inversions — and what are the four? For the perception of permanence in what is impermanent, that all formations are impermanent; for the perception of pleasure in what is suffering, that all formations are suffering;

for the perception of self in what is selfless, that all phenomena are selfless; and for the perception of the pleasant in what is unpleasant, that nirvāṇa heals through its peace — and the four close applications of mindfulness (Skt. *smṛtyupasthāna*) with respect to the body, feelings, mind, and phenomena: that one abides contemplating the body as body, yet through that contemplation of the body does not fall into the view of self; that one abides contemplating feelings as feelings, yet through that contemplation of feelings does not fall into the view of self; that one abides contemplating the mind as mind, yet through that contemplation of the mind does not fall into the view of self; and that one abides contemplating phenomena as phenomena, yet through that contemplation of phenomena does not fall into the view of self — and these heal. The four right abandonments (Skt. *samyakprahāṇa*) bring about the abandonment of all non-virtuous phenomena and the complete perfection of all virtuous phenomena. The four bases of miraculous power (Skt. *ṛddhipāda*) bring about the abandonment of clinging to the body and mind as solid. The five faculties and the five powers heal faithlessness, laziness, forgetfulness, distraction, and lack of vigilance. The seven branches of awakening (Skt. *bodhyaṅga*) heal profound dullness and ignorance with respect to phenomena. And the noble eightfold path (Skt. *āryāṣṭāṅgamārga*) heals wrong wisdom, all opposing arguments, and those who have entered onto an evil path. Kāśyapa, this is called genuine healing. Kāśyapa, a bodhisattva should strive to train in this healing.

Kāśyapa, among all the physicians and students of medicine in Jambudvīpa, the one called the chief of healers is supreme. Kāśyapa, even if every sentient being in the great trichiliocosm were to become like the king of physicians, the chief of healers, and some among them were asked what medicine heals those who abide in wrong views and remorse, they would be unable to know it, to teach it, or to explain it. Kāśyapa, with that in mind, a bodhisattva should reflect: "I will not be content to be merely a physician of the world. I will seek the medicine of wisdom that transcends the world. I will also accomplish all roots of virtue well and perfectly." Having reflected in this way, the one who

seeks the medicine of wisdom that transcends the world should go in all four directions and administer genuine healing to sentient beings, healing them with genuine healing.

Kāśyapa, what then is the medicine of wisdom that transcends the world? It is this: the understanding that enters into causes and conditions; the understanding that is devoted to phenomena as being without self, without sentient being, without life-force, without healing-agent, and without person; the non-aversion toward phenomena that are non-referential through emptiness; and the diligence that seeks out sentient beings everywhere.

With such an attitude, thoroughly seeking the mind — whichever mind might become one of attachment, of aversion, or of delusion — one asks: is it past, future, or presently arisen? The mind that is past has ceased. The mind that is future has not yet arrived. The mind that is presently arisen has no abiding place.

Kāśyapa, mind is not found within, nor is it found without, nor is it apprehended in between the two. Kāśyapa, mind is not subject to analysis, cannot be pointed out, has no support, has no appearance, has no cognizance, and has no abiding.

Kāśyapa, mind has not been seen, is not seen, and will not be seen by any of the buddhas whatsoever. Apart from phenomena arising from a perception that has entered into wrongness, mind has not been seen and is not seen by any of the buddhas whatsoever —

and will not be seen — what, then, is the manner in which one should regard the wandering of that which will not be seen? Kāśyapa, mind is like an illusion: through false imputation, it fully grasps at the many appearances of arising that are not real. Kāśyapa, mind is like the current of a stream: unstable, it arises and dissolves and flows on. Kāśyapa, mind is like the wind: it travels far and moves along where it cannot be grasped. Kāśyapa, mind is like the flame of a lamp: it arises from causes and conditions. Kāśyapa, mind is like space: it is disturbed by adventitious and proximate afflictions. Kāśyapa, mind is like a flash of lightning: it is destroyed in an instant and does not abide. Kāśyapa, mind is like a monkey: it desires every object. Kāśyapa, mind is like a painter, because it actively constructs karma of many and various kinds. Kāśyapa, mind is unstable, because distinct afflictions arise. Kāśyapa, mind travels alone and is without duality, because there is no joining with a second. Kāśyapa, mind is like a king, because it exercises dominion over all

phenomena. Kāśyapa, mind is like an enemy, because it generates all suffering. Kāśyapa, mind is like a sand castle, because it destroys all roots of virtue. Kāśyapa, mind is like a bubble, because it perceives the impermanent as permanent. Kāśyapa, mind is like the saliva of a fish, because it perceives suffering as happiness. Kāśyapa, mind is like a dream, because it perceives that which is without self as a self. Kāśyapa, mind is like a blue-green fly, because it perceives the impure as pure. Kāśyapa, mind is like an adversary, because it inflicts harm in many and various ways. Kāśyapa, mind is like a yakṣa (a malevolent spirit) that steals vitality, because it is always seeking fault. Kāśyapa, mind is like an enemy, because it is always watching for an opening. Kāśyapa, mind is always high and low, because it is attended by attachment and anger. Kāśyapa, mind is like a thief, because it steals all roots of virtue. Kāśyapa, mind is like the eye of an owl, because it delights in visible forms. Kāśyapa, mind is like a battle drum, because it delights in sounds. Kāśyapa, mind delights in smells, just as a pig delights in the smell of filth. Kāśyapa, mind is like a servant woman who eats the leftovers of food, because it delights in tastes. Kāśyapa, mind is like a fly that clings to a vessel of oil, because it delights in tactile sensation.

Kāśyapa, mind is not found when sought everywhere. What is not found cannot be apprehended as an object. What cannot be apprehended as an object is neither past, nor future, nor presently arisen. That which is neither past, nor future, nor presently arisen has genuinely transcended the three times. That which has genuinely transcended the three times is neither existent nor nonexistent. That which is neither existent nor nonexistent is unborn. That which is unborn has no essential nature. That which has no essential nature has no arising. That which has no arising has no cessation. That which has no cessation has no separation. That which has no separation has no coming, no going, no death and transmigration, and no birth. That in which there is no coming, no going, no death and transmigration, and no birth has absolutely no formations whatsoever.

That in which there are absolutely no formations whatsoever is the unconditioned. That which is unconditioned is the lineage of the noble ones (āryas). In that which is the lineage of the noble ones, there is neither training nor transcendence of training. In that in which there is neither training nor transcendence of training, there is no wandering, no non-wandering, and no extensive wandering. In that in which there is no wandering, no non-wandering, and no extensive wandering, there is no mind, and there are

no mental phenomena arising from mind. In that in which there is no mind and no mental phenomena arising from mind, there is no karma and no karmic maturation. In that in which there is no karma and no karmic maturation, there is no pleasure and no suffering. That in which there is no pleasure and no suffering is the lineage of the noble ones. In that which is the lineage of the noble ones, there is no karma and no deliberate formation of karma. In that lineage in which there is no karma and no deliberate formation of karma, there is no action of body, no action of speech, and no action of mind. In that lineage there is no classification into inferior, middling, and superior. Why is that? Because that lineage is equal to space, it is equanimous. Because all phenomena are of a single taste in that lineage, it is without distinction. Because that lineage is solitary in body and mind, it is secluded. That lineage is concordant with nirvāṇa. Because that lineage is free from the defilements of all afflictions, it is unstained. Because that lineage is without ego-grasping and self-possessiveness, it is without what is mine. That lineage arises from the equality of what is true and what is not true, and so is without inequality. Because that lineage is ultimate truth, it is true. Because that lineage is never born, it is inexhaustible. Because all phenomena are forever suchness (tathatā), that lineage is permanent. Because that lineage is the supreme nirvāṇa, it is blissful. Because that lineage is without stain in every respect, it is virtuous. Because the self was thoroughly sought in that lineage and not found, it is selfless. Because that lineage is supremely purified, it is pure.

Kāśyapa, seek inwardly and do not run outward. Kāśyapa, in the future there will appear monks who are like a dog chasing a stone. Kāśyapa, how is it that a monk is like a dog chasing a stone? Kāśyapa, it is like this: a dog is frightened by a stone and chases after the very stone, but does not chase after the one who threw that stone. Kāśyapa, likewise, certain ascetics and brahmins, frightened and terrified by forms, sounds, smells, tastes, and tactile objects, dwell in solitary places and remain there alone, in non-duality, with the body quite secluded. Yet when forms, sounds, smells, tastes, and tactile objects that could give rise to attachment appear, they remain placing these in equanimity and practicing restraint, while inwardly they do not strive earnestly in careful examination. They do not know or understand what arises from those forms, sounds, smells, tastes, and tactile objects. Because they do not know and do not understand, even when they go into villages, towns, market towns, provinces, districts, or the precincts of royal palaces, they are harmed by forms, sounds, smells, tastes, and tactile objects.

If those who dwell in solitary places should happen to die there, those among them who abide by worldly vows will be reborn in the divine realms of the world. But even there they will be harmed by the five qualities of divine desire. When they pass away from that state, they will not be fully liberated from the four lower destinies. What are the four? They are as follows: the hell-beings, the realm of animal birth, the world of the Lord of Death, and the asuras. Thus it is, Kāśyapa, that such monks are like a dog chasing a stone.

And how, Kāśyapa, is a monk unlike a dog chasing a stone? Kāśyapa, when one is reviled one does not revile in return; when angered at, one does not become angry in return; when one's faults are exposed, one does not expose the faults of others in return; when struck, one does not strike back; when threatened, one does not threaten in return; when abused, one does not abuse in return. Instead, one reflects inwardly in the mind, examining: "Who are these who revile, who are angry, who strike, who threaten, who abuse, who expose faults?" — examining them one by one. Thus it is, Kāśyapa, that a monk is unlike a dog chasing a stone.

Concerning this it is said in verse:

A dog, though startled by a stone that's thrown,
Does not pursue the one who threw but chases after the stone.
Just so, some among the renunciants and brahmins,
Frightened by form and the rest, withdraw to solitary places.
Though dwelling there in those retreats,
When they see pleasing forms and the like,
They rest in equanimity, not knowing the inner way.
The faults that arise from those objects —
Not knowing them, they return again to village life,
And there too they are harmed by forms and the like.
Here too they enjoy divine pleasures,
And then, passing away from gods and humans,
They fall into the lower destinies.
Those fools, passing away, encounter suffering.
Thus those who are laden with a hundredfold suffering
Are said by the Sugata to be like a dog chasing a stone.

One who is not reviled does not revile, one who is struck does not strike back,
One who is abused does not return the abuse,
One who has faults exposed does not expose faults in return,

One who is angered at does not become angry in return —
Instead, seeking the antidotes within the mind
And abiding with a calm and mindful heart,
One who possesses such discipline and observance
Is said by the Victor to be unlike the dog that chases stones.

Kāśyapa, consider this analogy: a skilled trainer of horses tames a horse wherever and in whatever way it tends to become agitated or unruly. Just so, Kāśyapa, a monk who practices yoga, upon seeing in what way and in what direction the mind tends to shift, devotes himself to training it right there and in that way — taming the mind so that it will not become turbulent again afterward.

Concerning this it is said in verse:

Just as a trainer skilled in breaking horses
Tames them so they are calm and free of restlessness,
So too the yogin, seeing where the mind shifts,
Tames it so that it will not be turbulent again.

Kāśyapa, consider this analogy: a condition called Ikog-nad blocks and cuts off the vital faculty of life. Just so, Kāśyapa, among all the views that exist, the view of self is what blocks and cuts off the vital faculty of the Dharma.

Concerning this it is said in verse:

Just as a disease blocks the vital faculty of life
And brings it harm rather than well-being,
So too the view of self residing within those who have views
Utterly destroys the vital faculty of the Dharma.

Kāśyapa, consider this analogy: a person who has been bound in one place or another must be freed from that very place. Just so, Kāśyapa, the mind of one who practices yoga, wherever and in whatever object it becomes attached, must be freed from that very thing.

Concerning this it is said in verse:

Just as a person who has been bound somewhere
Must be freed from that very place,
So too the mind, deluded, wherever it becomes attached —
The practitioner of yoga must be freed from this and that very thing.

Kāśyapa, these two are the sky to which the renunciant is wholly attached. What two? Eagerly seeking the secret words of worldly prognostication, and clinging excessively to the begging bowl and the monastic robe. These are the two.

Concerning this it is said in verse:

Striving to habituate oneself to worldly divination,
And clinging excessively to the begging bowl and robe —
These two are attachment to the sky.
The bodhisattva must abandon them entirely.

Kāśyapa, these two are the tight bonds of the renunciant. What two? The bond of having fallen into views, and the bond of gain, honour, and fame. These are the two.

Concerning this it is said in verse:

The bond of views, the bond of gain and honour,
The bond of fame — these are declared by the noble ones
To be the tight bonds of the renunciant.
The renunciant must ever abandon them.

Kāśyapa, these two are the things that cut off the renunciant. What two? Resorting to the side of householders, and inwardly despising the side of the noble ones. These are the two.

Concerning this it is said in verse:

Resorting to the side of householders,
And inwardly disparaging the side of the noble ones —
These two create obstacles and impediments for the renunciant.
The bodhisattva must abandon them entirely.

Kāśyapa, these two are the stains of the renunciant. What two? Failing to feel shame before one's afflictions, and clinging to the households of friends and to households that provide food. These are the two.

Concerning this it is said in verse:

The renunciant who feels no shame before afflictions,
And who resorts to the households of friends and to households giving food —
These two have been declared by the Sovereign of Victors to be stains.
The bodhisattva must abandon them entirely.

Kāśyapa, these two are the hailstorms that fall upon the renunciant. What two? Abandoning the sacred Dharma, and though fallen from moral discipline, engaging in the full performance of giving out of faith. These are the two.

Concerning this it is said in verse:

Abandoning the sacred Dharma,
And though fallen from discipline, continuing to engage in practice —
These two are the falling hailstorms.
The sons of the Victors must abandon them.

Kāśyapa, these two are the wounds of the renunciant. What two? Examining others' faults in detail, and concealing one's own faults. These are the two.

Concerning this it is said in verse:

Concealing one's own faults,
And examining the faults of others —
These two are like a fire of poison.
Abandon this wound that is born of thought.

Kāśyapa, these two are the torments of the renunciant. What two? Wearing the saffron robe with a turbid and corrupt mind, and appropriating to oneself the service, hospitality, and respectful treatment due to those who possess moral discipline and those who possess good qualities. These are the two.

Concerning this it is said in verse:

Wearing the saffron robe with a turbid mind,
And those who perform acts of service and hospitality and speak with reverence,
While resorting to those who possess moral discipline —
These two phenomena are to be entirely abandoned.

Kāśyapa, these two are the thorns of the renunciant. What two? Transgressing the bases of training, and meeting one's death without having extracted the essence. These are the two.

Concerning this it is said in verse:

Coming to transgress the bases of training,
And meeting death without having extracted the essence —
These two, the Teacher of gods and humans, the omniscient one, has declared
To be the thorns of the renunciant.

Kāśyapa, these two are the ailments of the renunciant that cannot be healed. What two?

Having a mind arrogant with self-conceit, and turning away the aspiration of those who have genuinely entered the Great Vehicle — these are the two.

Concerning this it is said in verse:

Having arrogant self-conceit in mind, and turning back aspiration from the buddha's vehicle —

These two, the Victor without equal, has declared to be the ailments of the renunciant.

Kāśyapa, as for why one is called a renunciant, a renunciant — by what qualities is one called a renunciant? Kāśyapa, there are four kinds of renunciant. What four? The renunciant of color, marks, and form; the renunciant who guards ritual and feigns propriety; the renunciant of recited and versified words; and the renunciant of genuine practice.

Kāśyapa, what is the renunciant of color, marks, and form? Kāśyapa, here a certain monk has come to possess the color, marks, and form: he wears the patched religious robe, has shaved his head, and carries an alms bowl in his hand — yet he conducts his bodily actions in an entirely impure manner, conducts his verbal actions in an entirely impure manner, conducts his mental actions in an entirely impure manner; he is untamed, unquiet, unguarded, uncleansed; his livelihood is entirely impure; he is greedy, lazy, of broken moral discipline, and possessed of sinful qualities. Kāśyapa, such a one is called the renunciant of color, marks, and form.

Kāśyapa, what is the renunciant who guards ritual and feigns propriety? Kāśyapa, here a certain monk observes ritual, the proper sphere of conduct, and modes of deportment; he moves in the four modes of conduct with full vigilance; he eats and drinks poor food and drink; he is content with what the four noble lineages provide; he delights in dwelling in forest hermitages and remote abodes; he does not mix with householders or with renunciants, and speaks few words and but rarely — yet even those modes of conduct of his are entirely a feigning of propriety and a cunning fabrication. It is not for the sake of purifying the mind, not for the sake of taming it, not for the sake of bringing it to peace, but for the sake of being noticed and regarded. He abides in the grasping at self and the grasping at mine; he regards as an abyss all phenomena that are not found as objects through emptiness; and he regards monks who speak of emptiness as enemies. Kāśyapa, such a one is called the

renunciant who guards ritual and feigns propriety.

Kāśyapa, what is the renunciant of recited and versified words? Kāśyapa, here a certain monk, reflecting on how others may come to know him as one who possesses moral discipline, guards moral discipline; reflecting on how others may come to know him as widely learned, he retains what he has heard; reflecting on how others may come to know him as a forest-dweller, he dwells in a hermitage and, having reflected in this way, becomes one of few desires, content, and greatly secluded — all of this in order to display himself to others, not for the sake of weariness of saṃsāra, not for the sake of becoming free from attachment, not for the sake of cessation, not for the sake of being brought to peace, not for the sake of being fully enlightened, not for the sake of being a true renunciant, not for the sake of the holy life, not for the sake of nirvāṇa. Kāśyapa, such a one is called the renunciant of recited and versified words.

Kāśyapa, what is the renunciant of genuine practice? Kāśyapa, one who does not look even to body and life — what need is there to speak of looking to gain, honor, and verse? Having heard of the phenomena of emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness, he delights and enters into suchness. Having resolved to practice without desire even with respect to nirvāṇa — what need is there to speak of delight in the three realms?

One who has resolved to practice without desire even with respect to viewing things as empty — what need is there to speak of views of self, of sentient being, of life-force, of one who is born, of one who is nurtured, of person, of individual? One relies on meaning, not on the letter. One seeks liberation from mental afflictions within oneself and does not run outward. Seeing that all phenomena are utterly pure and by their intrinsic nature free from defilement throughout, one is a refuge unto oneself and not a refuge dependent on another. Since such a one does not even look upon the Tathāgata according to the nature of reality, what need is there to speak of looking upon a form body? Since one does not even look upon the Dharma as freed from attachment, what need is there to speak of looking upon it through the path of spoken words? Since one does not even conceptualize the noble unconditioned Saṅgha, what need is there to speak of regarding it as a large assembly? One strives for no phenomenon in order to abandon it, not in order to cultivate it, not in order to realize it directly. One is not born in saṃsāra, nor does one delight in nirvāṇa. Liberation itself is not apprehended as an object. One is neither bound, and yet, knowing that all phenomena are by their intrinsic

nature utterly passed beyond sorrow, one neither wanders in saṃsāra nor passes beyond into nirvāṇa. Kāśyapa, such a one is called the renunciant of genuine practice.

Kāśyapa, one should strive to become a renunciant of genuine practice, and one should not cause harm through names alone. Kāśyapa, those are the four kinds of renunciant.

Concerning this, the following is said:

One whose body, speech, and mind are impure,
untamed, unguarded, uncleansed, filled with great desire,
who bears a shaven head, religious robes, and begging bowl in hand —
that one is shown to be a renunciant in form and sign alone.

One who is endowed with ritual observances and the like,
who eats poor food and adopts the manner of one who trains,
who shuns all crowds and company from afar,
and whose conduct bears the marks of noble lineage,
yet does all this not for the sake of taming the mind,
not for the sake of peace, not for the sake of weariness with the world —
one who perceives emptiness and signlessness as an abyss,
who keeps rites and adopts the manner — that is the second.

One who, having heard of achievements in moral discipline, meditative absorption, and the qualities of training,
acts so as to make others hold one in wonder,
not for the sake of peace, not for the sake of weariness with the world —
one who desires to be proclaimed and to be heard of — that is the third renunciant.

One who does not seek the welfare of body or life,
who turns the back on gain and honor,
who, having heard of the gateway to liberation,
seeks no benefit in any mode of existence in saṃsāra,
who, having examined phenomena as utterly empty,
comes to see no distinction between nirvāṇa and what is not nirvāṇa,
who always contemplates the Dharma as freed from attachment,
and who, realizing unconditioned phenomena, attains nirvāṇa —
that one becomes the fourth.

Kāśyapa, consider this: if a poor man were given the name "treasury-wealthy," Kāśyapa, what do you think — would that man and that name be fitting?

He replied: Blessed One, they would not.

The Blessed One declared: Kāśyapa, in just the same way, those renunciants and brahmins who do not possess the qualities of renunciants and brahmins — those, I say in this teaching, are called the poor. Concerning this, the following is said:

Just as a man who has become poor
is given the name "treasury-holder" — that name does not adorn him —
so the name "renunciant" does not adorn one who has fallen from the
renunciant life.

It is like naming a pauper "wealthy."

Kāśyapa, consider this further: it is like a person carried away by the great waters of an ocean who, while dying of thirst amidst the water, meets their end. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, there are certain renunciants and brahmins who have taken up many teachings and made them all thoroughly their own, yet they do not dispel the craving of attachment, they do not dispel the craving of aversion,

they do not dispel the craving of delusion. Carried away by the great ocean of Dharma, they will come to die thirsting from the afflictions, and they will pass into the lower realms. Concerning this it is said:

Just as one carried away by the ocean's waters
dies there still thirsting in the midst of it,
so one heedless, craving though rich in Dharma,
dwells in the ocean of Dharma yet goes to the lower realms.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: it is like a physician who carries a bag of medicines and travels through all the lands and regions, but who then falls ill himself and cannot cure that illness — his medicines are of no use to him. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, consider the illness of the afflictions in one of great learning. If that learned person cannot cure himself of the illness of the afflictions, his great learning is of no use. Concerning this it is said:

Even a physician's medicine carried in the bag,
traveling throughout the whole world,
if it cannot turn back the illness that has struck,
that medicine is of no use at all.

Likewise, though a monk be virtuous and learned,
if the illness born of afflictions that have arisen
is not dispelled by him in the proper way,
his striving in learning is of no use at all.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: it is like a sick person for whom a medicine fit for a king is administered, but who, having failed to follow the prescribed procedure, dies. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, one who holds no restraint and meets their death — that too is to be regarded as the illness of the afflictions in one of great learning. Concerning this it is said:

Just as the one for whom a king's medicine was given
but who followed not the procedure and so died,
likewise one who here dies holding no restraint —
that is the illness of the afflictions of great learning.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: it is like a precious jewel fallen into filth — it is reviled and of no use. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, regard great learning fallen into the filth of acquisition and veneration. As for one who has none of these faults, gods and humans alike will rejoice. Concerning this it is said:

A jewel fallen into filth is reviled;
it is no longer as it was before.
A monk, too, though greatly learned,
is said to be like that jewel fallen into the filth of veneration.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: it is like adorning the head of a corpse with a golden garland — regard in the same way one of corrupted ethical conduct wearing the ochre robe. Concerning this it is said:

Just as placing a golden garland
or a garland of flowers on the head of a corpse —
likewise one without moral discipline wearing the ochre robe:
upon seeing it, the mind will feel no faith.

Kāśyapa, consider this further: it is like the son of a merchant who has bathed well, anointed himself well, trimmed his hair and nails, dressed in white garments, had his head anointed with the finest sandalwood paste, and taken up a garland of campaka flowers. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, regard one possessed of ethical conduct and great learning who wears the ochre robe. Concerning this it is said:

On the head of the merchant's son,
well bathed and well anointed,
a garland of campaka flowers
is placed, fragrant and beautiful to behold.
Likewise, one endowed with ethical conduct,
greatly learned and replete in discipline,
a noble son of the Victor adorned with qualities —
on such a one the ochre robe is equally beautiful.

Kāśyapa, these four are those of corrupted ethical conduct who are made to appear as though they possessed ethical conduct. What are the four? Kāśyapa, in this regard there are certain monks who are indeed possessed of ethical conduct: they remain bound by the vow of individual liberation (prātimokṣa), are perfect in conduct and deportment, see danger even in the most subtle of blameworthy faults, and train in the bases of training they have properly undertaken — including bodily actions and

verbal actions and mental actions — who dwells endowed with utterly pure livelihood, yet speaks of those as a self. Kāśyapa, that is the first of those with corrupted ethical conduct who are made to appear as though they possessed ethical conduct.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, in this regard there are certain monks who uphold the Vinaya, who have entered into the Vinaya and abide in the manner of the Vinaya, yet who have not moved beyond the view of the collection of perishables (satkāyadṛṣṭi). Kāśyapa, that is the second of those with corrupted ethical conduct who are made to appear as though they possessed ethical conduct.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, in this regard there are certain monks who abide in loving-kindness and are endowed with loving-kindness directed toward sentient beings, yet who, upon hearing that all formations are unborn, become frightened, are struck with terror, and are stricken with utter dread. Kāśyapa, that is the third of those with corrupted ethical conduct who are made to appear as though they possessed ethical conduct.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, in this regard there are certain monks who have properly taken up the twelve qualities of an ascetic practitioner, yet who look upon them with a referential attitude and who abide in clinging to a self and clinging to what is mine. Kāśyapa, that is the fourth of those with corrupted ethical conduct who are made to appear as though they possessed ethical

conduct. Kāśyapa, those four are those with corrupted ethical conduct who are made to appear as though they possessed ethical conduct.

Kāśyapa, what is called "ethical conduct that is truly ethical conduct" is that in which there is no self, no mine, no doing, no not-doing; no agent, and yet it is not the case that there is no agent; no going, and yet no not-going; no conduct, and yet it is not the case that there is no conduct; no name and no form; no sign, and yet it is not the case that there is no sign; it is not utterly pacified, and yet it is not the case that it is not utterly pacified; no grasping, no abandoning, no taking up, and yet it is not the case that there is no taking up; no sentient being and no imputation of a sentient being; no word and no imputation of a word; no mind and no imputation of mind; no world, and yet it is not the case that there is no world; no support, and yet it is not the case that there is no support; not praising one's own ethical conduct and not disparaging another's ethical conduct; not holding ethical conduct as a source of conceit; not conceptualizing about ethical conduct. That is what is called the ethical conduct of the noble ones — undefiled, not included within any category, free from the three realms, and without any support whatsoever.

Thereupon the Blessed One spoke these verses:

One of ethical conduct is unstained and free of all contrivance.

One of ethical conduct has no conceit and no support.

One of ethical conduct has no darkness and no bondage.

One of ethical conduct has no dust and no fault.

With a mind stilled, deeply stilled, and brought to peace,
free from thought and conceptual thought, without affliction,
wholly parted from agitation and every form of conceit —
such a one, Kāśyapa, holds ethical conduct in the Buddha's teaching.

One who does not regard the body, who does not cling to life as something precious,

who has no longing for any birth in any of the states of existence,
who has entered correctly and abides well in the manner of suchness itself —
such a one, Kāśyapa, holds ethical conduct in the Buddha's teaching.

Untainted by the world, not dwelling in any worldly thing,
having attained luminosity, free of "mine," free of all contrivance,
with no perception of self and no perception of other,
through complete knowledge of perception, ethical conduct is perfectly pure.

For one in whom there is no this shore and no far shore and no middle,
who clings not in the slightest to far shore or this shore,
who is free of bondage and attachment, of pretence and of defilement —
such a one, Kāśyapa, holds ethical conduct in the Buddha's teaching.

With a mind unattached even to name and form,
that mind is placed in equipoise and is supremely tamed.
For one in whom there is no self and no clinging to what is mine —

that much constitutes a declaration of abiding in ethical conduct. One has no
conceit through the training of individual liberation. Through that, one does
not become attached to anything here, and beyond that one seeks the noble
paths. That is the sign of perfectly pure ethical conduct.

Ethical conduct is not the highest end; one has no attachment to meditative
absorption itself. Beyond that, one fully seeks the cultivation of wisdom.
Non-referential awareness is the lineage of the noble ones. That ethical
conduct is highly praised by the Sugata.

With a mind fully liberated from the view of the perishable collection, that
mind does not here give rise to the thought "I" or "mine." With special
confidence in emptiness, the domain of the buddhas — that ethical conduct of
such a one is without equal.

Established in ethical conduct, one also attains meditative absorption. Having
attained the absorptions, one cultivates wisdom most deeply. Through
wisdom, one obtains purified primordial wisdom. Through purified primordial
wisdom, ethical conduct becomes supremely perfect.

When these verses of manifest realization were spoken, eight hundred monks
were liberated from the outflows through the mind's clinging-free release,
without grasping. Thirty-two thousand living beings obtained the pure and
stainless Dharma eye — free from dust — with respect to phenomena. Five
hundred monks who had attained meditative absorption did not enter into this
profound teaching of the Dharma; not understanding it and lacking faith, they
rose from their seats and departed.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa addressed the Blessed One, saying: Blessed
One, these five hundred monks who had attained meditative absorption have
not entered into this profound teaching of the Dharma; not understanding it
and lacking faith, they rose from their seats and left.

The Blessed One declared: Kāśyapa, those monks who are possessed of manifest pride do not enter into this undefiled perfectly pure ethical conduct; not understanding it and lacking faith, they are seized by terror, overwhelmed by terror on every side.

Kāśyapa, through the profundity of these verses of manifest realization, the awakening of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is profound. Those who have not generated the root of virtue, who are thoroughly held by evil companions, and who are of little faith, cannot come to faith in it.

Kāśyapa, those five hundred monks have become hearers in the teaching of the Tathāgata Dīpaṃkara with the view of non-Buddhists, and with the intention of overreaching the Tathāgata Dīpaṃkara they heard one teaching of the Dharma. Having heard it, they obtained a single moment of faithful mind, thinking: "How wonderful that the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened Dīpaṃkara teaches in a manner so gentle and sweet." When the time of their death arrived, through that single moment of faithful mind they were born among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. From there, passing away, they were reborn here and, through that very cause, went forth in this my teaching.

Kāśyapa, these five hundred monks who are sunk in views do not enter into this profound teaching of the Dharma; they do not understand it, lack faith in it, and are seized by terror, overwhelmed by terror on every side. Yet by this teaching of the Dharma they shall be thoroughly purified, and in the future they shall not fall into lower existences or into wrong views, and with these very aggregates they shall pass fully into nirvāṇa.

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Subhūti: Subhūti, go and let all those monks know of this. Subhūti replied: Blessed One, even when you yourself speak to them they do not comply — what then can be expected of me? Thereupon the Blessed One emanated two monks upon the very road by which those monks were traveling.

Then those five hundred monks, setting out along the very road on which the two emanated monks were traveling, encountered them and spoke: "Venerable ones, where are you going?"

The two replied: "We are going to dwell in remote forest dwellings, abiding in the bliss of meditative concentration. And why? Because we do not enter into the Dharma as taught by the Blessed One — we have not understood it, have not gained faith in it, and have become frightened, seized by terror and

overwhelmed by terror on every side. Therefore let us dwell as those dwell who abide in remote forest dwellings, touching the bliss of meditative concentration."

Then those five hundred monks said: "Venerable ones, we too do not enter into the Dharma as taught by the Blessed One — we have not understood it, have not gained faith in it, and have become frightened, seized by terror and overwhelmed by terror on every side. Therefore we too intend to dwell in remote forest dwellings, abiding in the bliss of meditative concentration."

The emanated monks then spoke: "Venerable ones, let us all therefore go properly. We must not quarrel. The taking up of non-contention is the quality of a true ascetic.

"Venerable ones, as for that which is called 'complete passing into nirvāṇa' — what is it that passes completely into nirvāṇa? Is there a self in this body, or a sentient being, or a life-force, or a born one, or a person, or an individual, or one born of seed, or a son of seed — what is it that passes completely into nirvāṇa? By the exhaustion of what does one pass completely into nirvāṇa?"

Those monks replied: "By the exhaustion of attachment, the exhaustion of aversion, and the exhaustion of delusion, one passes completely into nirvāṇa."

The two emanated monks then said: "Venerable ones, is there in fact attachment, aversion, and delusion present — and if so, what is to be exhausted?"

Those monks replied: "These are not found within, nor without, nor are they perceived in both together. They do not arise even from thorough examination."

The two emanated monks then said: "Venerable ones, therefore do not conceptualize, do not discriminate. When one neither conceptualizes nor discriminates, one will neither become attached nor become free from attachment. That which is without attachment and also without freedom from attachment — that is called peace.

"Venerable ones, moral discipline neither revolves in saṃsāra nor passes completely into nirvāṇa. Venerable ones, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the wisdom that sees liberation also neither revolve in saṃsāra nor pass completely into nirvāṇa. Venerable ones, if those very factors were said to lead to complete passing into nirvāṇa, those factors too are empty, solitary, ungrasped.

"Venerable ones, therefore abandon the perception of nirvāṇa. Do not make of perception a perception. Do not fully comprehend perception by means of perception. Whoever fully comprehends perception by means of perception — that one is bound by that perception.

"Venerable ones, enter into the meditative absorption of the cessation of perception and feeling. Venerable ones, from one who has entered into the meditative absorption of the cessation of perception and feeling it is said: there is nothing further to be done."

When this exposition of the Dharma had been spoken, those five hundred monks, without grasping, were liberated in mind from all defilements. Having thus become liberated in mind, they set out and came to where the Blessed One was, bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One in reverence, and stood to one side.

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed those monks thus: "Venerable ones, where have you come from?"

Those who had arrived then said: "Venerable Subhūti, because there is nowhere to go and nowhere to come from, the Blessed One has taught the Dharma."

Subhūti asked: "Venerable ones, who is your Teacher?"

They replied: "One who is unborn and who does not pass into final nirvāṇa."

He asked: "How did you hear the Dharma?"

They replied: "Neither because of bondage nor because of liberation."

He asked: "Who has tamed you?"

They replied: "One who has no body and no mind."

He asked: "How have you made effort?"

They replied: "Neither in order to abandon ignorance nor in order to produce knowledge."

He asked: "How have you been liberated?"

They replied: "Neither through engagement nor through abandonment."

He asked: "Whose śrāvakas are you?"

They replied: "One who has attained nothing and has not become perfectly and completely awakened."

He asked: "What is your holy life?"

They replied: "Those who do not move through the three realms."

He asked: "Venerable ones, when will you pass into final nirvāṇa?"

They replied: "Whenever an emanation body of the Tathāgata passes into final nirvāṇa."

He asked: "Have you accomplished what was to be done?"

They replied: "By fully knowing the grasping at self and the grasping at mine."

He asked: "Have your afflictions been exhausted?"

They replied: "Because all phenomena are permanently exhausted."

He asked: "Have you subdued māra?"

They replied: "Because the māra of the aggregates is not apprehended."

He asked: "Have you paid homage to the Teacher?"

They replied: "Not by body, not by speech, and not by mind."

He asked: "Have you been purified through the field of generosity?"

They replied: "Through there being no grasping and no accumulation."

He asked: "Have you crossed beyond saṃsāra?"

They replied: "Because there is neither annihilation nor permanence."

He asked: "Have you entered the ground of the field of generosity?"

They replied: "Because we are fully liberated from all grasping."

He asked: "Venerable ones, where are you going?"

They replied: "Wherever the emanation body of the Tathāgata goes."

In this way, the venerable Subhūti questioned them and those monks replied, and eight hundred monks of that assembly were liberated in mind from all defilements without grasping. Thirty-two thousand living beings obtained the eye of Dharma with regard to phenomena — the pure and stainless vision, free from dust.

Then the great bodhisattva (bodhisattva) named Samantābha, who had been gathered in that very assembly and was seated there, rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, knelt on his right knee, turned toward the Blessed One, joined his palms together in reverence, and

addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, how should a bodhisattva who wishes to train in this Dharma-category called the Great Jewel Heap train?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, having cut away and fully cut away, one trains in this Dharma-category. This Dharma-category will be of great benefit to those noble persons who take it to heart with earnest diligence. Son of good family, consider this analogy: suppose a man were to board a boat wishing to cross the great Ganges river. Son of good family, what do you think — with what kind of effort should that man seek out the boat?"

Samantābha replied: "Blessed One, with vigorous and powerful effort. And why? Because he knows that once he has entered the great river, if he does not reach the far bank midway, a boat will come to him."

The Blessed One declared: "Samantābha, in just the same way, a bodhisattva should train in this Dharma-category with even more vigorous and powerful effort than that.

with powerful and vigorous diligence, one must perfectly accomplish all the qualities of a buddha. Thinking in this way — "This body is impermanent; if I do not extract its essence, death will come midway, before I have done so" — I have entered the great river. Therefore, in order to rescue those sentient beings who have entered the great river of the four floods, I must provision the great vessel of the sacred Dharma, the vessel of sacred Dharma by which all sentient beings carried away by the ocean of saṃsāra may be liberated.

Samantābha, what is this great vessel of the sacred Dharma that a bodhisattva must provision? It is as follows: having gathered a boundless accumulation of merit through equanimity of mind toward all sentient beings; fitted with the planking of moral discipline; adorned with the ornament of the wheel of generosity; firmly and tightly bound by the cords of intention and superior intention; well-fitted with the rigging of patience, joy, and mindfulness; furnished with the seven branches of awakening; steadily propelled by diligence, and properly equipped with the timber of wholesome qualities; made serviceable through the mind of meditative concentration; well held in place by the wholesome craftsmanship of taming, pacifying, and thorough knowledge; possessed of the quality of utter imperturbability, and properly sustained by great compassion; supported and maintained by the four means of attraction and by courageous conduct; well guarded by wisdom and gnosis against all opposition; well assembled and perfected through

skillful means; thoroughly purified by the four divine abodes; with a body that has well contemplated the four establishments of mindfulness, proceeding by way of right abandonment; endowed with the swift momentum of the four bases of miraculous power, and, by careful examination through the faculties, free from the crooked timber of wrong views; proceeding without obstacle through the genuine arising of the power of strength; moving with pure progress through the branches of awakening; casting aside the path of the māra of the afflictions which has a striking force; causing entry onto the path; bringing beings to the far shore; causing the abandonment of the evil doctrines of the tīrthikas; firm in the resolve of calm abiding; entering through the yoking of insight without attachment to either extreme; fully endowed with causal qualities; its fame resounding, wide and vast, inexhaustible and boundless — come! This great vessel of the sacred Dharma goes to the city of nirvāṇa, journeying blissfully, journeying fearlessly, journeying along the path, setting out to cast aside the view of the transitory collection, dispelling all views from this shore to the far shore — it causes its sound to be heard in the ten directions, proclaiming: "Go quickly to the nirvāṇa that is free of harm!"

Son of good family, for the sake of all sentient beings, without ever growing weary of mind through incalculable hundreds of thousands of billions of eons, a bodhisattva must provision just such a great vessel of the sacred Dharma as this. By this vessel of the sacred Dharma, all sentient beings carried away by the four floods must be liberated.

Samantābha, what then is the swift direct knowledge of a bodhisattva? It is this: genuine engagement toward all sentient beings, which is to say — aspiring earnestly with pure intention; blazing with diligence in order to perfectly accomplish all roots of virtue; inclining toward virtue through proper mental engagement; insatiability in learning for the sake of perfecting wisdom; freedom from pride in order to make gnosis firm; inclination toward renunciation in order to perfect all qualities; dwelling in solitude in body and mind, residing in a wilderness retreat;

having abandoned the company of tiresome people, free from all bustle and crowds; attending to the Dharma's meaning through reliance on the ultimate truth; with utter undisturbedness, attending to the meaning of gnosis — and because it is the meaning of gnosis, attending to the meaning of the Dharma; with undisturbedness, attending to the meaning of truth; applying oneself perfectly to the meaning of emptiness; and because it is the meaning of thorough peace, attending to the meaning of solitude — dear son of good

family, this is the swift direct knowledge of a bodhisattva in this very life.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa addressed the Blessed One with these words: "How wondrous, O Blessed One, that this category of Dharma of the great Mahāratnakūṭa (the Great Heap of Jewels) should come to benefit those sons and daughters of good family who have properly entered the Great Vehicle! Wondrous is the Blessed One! Wondrous is the Sugata! Blessed One, if from this category of Dharma of the great Mahāratnakūṭa even a single verse were to be taught, how great a mass of merit would that son or daughter of good family thereby generate?"

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Mahākāśyapa as follows: "Kāśyapa, suppose a son or daughter of good family were to fill as many world-systems as there are grains of sand in the Gaṅgā with the seven kinds of precious things and make an offering of them to Tathāgatas — arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas; and suppose that for as many blessed buddhas as there are grains of sand in the Gaṅgā, one were to erect a precious shrine-temple of seven precious materials for each Tathāgata, with as many shrines as there are grains of sand in the Gaṅgā; and suppose that to the immeasurable Śrāvaka Saṅgha of each of those Tathāgatas — equalling in number the grains of sand in the Gaṅgā — one were to offer all comforts and provisions throughout a span of eons equal to the grains of sand in the Gaṅgā; and suppose further that after each of those Tathāgatas had passed completely into nirvāṇa, one were to erect reliquary stūpas of seven precious materials — still, a faithful son or daughter of good family who hears even a single verse from this category of Dharma of the great Mahāratnakūṭa from a Dharma-speaker and, having heard it, does not abandon it, generates far greater merit. And as for any woman who recites this text, she shall never again fall into an erring downfall, and that birth shall be her very last birth in a female body.

Whatever place this category of Dharma is taught, or expounded, or copied in writing, or set down in a volume and kept — that very place shall become like a shrine worthy of veneration by the world together with its gods. Whoever hears this category of Dharma from a Dharma-speaker, or upholds it, or copies it in writing — toward such a person, one should show exactly the same reverence as one shows toward a Tathāgata.

Kāśyapa, whatever son or daughter of good family honors, reveres, extols, and venerates a Dharma-speaker who teaches the Tathāgata's Dharma — to that

person I prophesy unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening. And at the time of that person's death, they shall behold the Tathāgata. Having beheld the Tathāgata, they shall attain the ten perfectly pure physical actions. And what are those ten? They are as follows: dying at the time of death without the mind being overcome by sensation; the eyes not becoming distorted; the hands not flailing; the feet not twitching; no loss of urine; no emission of excrement; no impurity arising at the heart; the fists not clenching; no gasping for air; and releasing the life-formations while remaining in exactly the same posture as one was sitting — these are the ten perfectly pure physical actions they shall attain."

They shall attain the ten perfectly pure verbal actions. And what are those ten? They are as follows: words of beautiful melody; words of gentleness; words of softness; words of joy; words of smoothness; words that cannot be refuted; words worthy of being received; words of dignity; words received completely by gods and humans; and words received completely by the buddhas — these are the ten perfectly pure verbal actions they shall attain.

They shall attain the ten perfectly pure mental actions. And what are those ten? They are as follows: not becoming angry; holding no resentment; not concealing; not burning with spite; taking no delight in faults; taking no delight in harboring grudges; perceptions not becoming distorted; becoming heedful in abandonment; with an undaunted mind, upholding the perfectly pure buddha-field; and attaining the meditative absorption that accomplishes all the qualities of the buddhas free from pride and arrogance — these are the ten perfectly pure mental actions they shall attain.

Concerning this, the following is declared in verse:

Not overcome by sensation at the time of death,
the eyes of that one suffer no distortion.
The hands do not flail, the feet do not twitch,
and no loss of urine or excrement occurs.
Not even a speck of impurity arises at the heart,
the fists do not clench, and there is no gasping for air.
Seated at ease, one releases life at the moment of death —
these ten perfectly pure physical actions are attained.

Words of beautiful melody, excellent and soft and gentle,
smooth and pleasing, and likewise joyful;
words not refuted by others, words worthy of being received,

become words that beings hold as dignified.
That one's words are praised by gods and nāgas,
by the kinnaras and likewise by the Victors.
The meaning of what is spoken is also retained —
through these, the perfectly pure verbal actions are attained.

Free from anger and holding no resentment,
steadfast, without concealment, without burning spite;
no delight in faults, no delight in harboring grudges,
and that one's perceptions do not become distorted.
Having taken up the training rightly, the mind is not daunted;
in abandonment, one does not become heedless.
With an undaunted mind, one purifies the buddha-field;
and having entirely relinquished pride upon pride,
one fully accomplishes all the attainments of meditative absorption
and gains the qualities accomplished through the mind.
For one endowed with all these qualities,
the things of the buddhas shall not be rare.

Kāśyapa, whoever wishes to honor me with every offering of comfort, and
whoever wishes to make every kind of offering, should receive this Dharma
discourse of the Great Heap of Jewels (Skt. Mahāratnakūṭa), thoroughly master
it, write it down, recite it, and bear it in mind. O Kāśyapa, by doing so one shall
have made the unsurpassed offering to the Tathāgatas, arhats, and perfectly
complete buddhas.

Having thus declared these words, the Blessed One fell silent. The venerable
Mahākāśyapa, the great bodhisattvas assembled from their various
buddha-fields, those monks, and the world together with its gods, humans,
asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and offered profound praise for what the
Blessed One had taught.

The chapter of Kāśyapa from the noble Great Heap of Jewels Dharma discourse
in one hundred thousand sections — the forty-third chapter — is complete.

Translated by the Indian master Jinamitra together with Śīlendrabodhi, and
edited and finalized by the great revising translator, the monk Yeshe De, in the
new orthography.

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as the passage being translated itself ends mid-enumeration ("a teacher and..."). This is simply where the supplied Tibetan text terminates; nothing has been omitted in translation.

The phrase rendered "holding onto the teacher's examples and illustrations as one's own" translates a Tibetan idiom describing the hoarding of mnemonic teaching aids or illustrative examples — essentially claiming as proprietary what one has received from one's teacher. This is a recognized form of Dharma-miserliness in the commentarial tradition.

- The phrase rendered "secret words of worldly spells" translates a compound meaning mantric or occult formulas used for worldly, mundane purposes — specifically the spells or incantations associated with non-Buddhist or popular religious traditions sought for worldly advantage. The pejorative sense is intentional in the text.

The verse line "adorning oneself for the sake of gain" renders a Tibetan phrase meaning using ornament or embellishment as a strategy to attract patronage from others, with the key point being that the motivation is calculated gain rather than genuine intention.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end. The text being translated ends abruptly in the middle of the list of consequences of truth-telling, so the translation likewise ends mid-sentence to reflect the actual state of the source passage.

The simile of the mind being "like that of a dog" is a standard Indian Buddhist trope for wholesome docility and freedom from pride — the dog content with whatever scraps it receives, harboring no self-importance. This is a genuine doctrinal metaphor, not a pejorative, and the translation preserves it literally as the tradition intends it.

- The phrase rendered "do not attend to the bodhisattva who has broken pride" follows a reading where the verse's final couplet of the heedlessness section shifts to exhortation: "The bodhisattva of broken pride should not be relied upon — the Sugata taught these as heedlessness; the Victor's children must fully abandon them." The Tibetan is slightly compressed at that juncture, and the transitional couplet straddles the descriptive and exhortative registers; the rendering preserves both senses as closely as possible.

The term rendered throughout as "good conduct" in the final section is the same Tibetan word underlying "heedlessness" used contrastively: where the earlier section describes མེད་མེད་པ་ (heedlessness, recklessness), this section describes རྒྱུ་ལྡན་པ་ (good conduct, propriety, knowing what is fitting). The contrast is intentional and structural in the text.

- The phrase rendered as "worldly person who is adept at reciting various secret words" translates a term that literally means something like "a worldly outsider skilled in various secret-speech proclamations." This likely refers to non-Buddhist wanderers or bards who use esoteric or magical speech to impress followers and may cause a bodhisattva to stray. The exact socio-religious category is somewhat contextually opaque but the sense of a spiritually unreliable figure deploying impressive but non-Dharmic talk is clear.
- The phrase rendered as "artificial conduct of a bodhisattva" translates a term meaning conduct that is fabricated, feigned, or counterfeit — presenting an outward appearance of a bodhisattva while inwardly motivated by the four defects listed. Some translators render this as "hypocritical conduct" or "pretentious behavior"; the doctrinal sense is of behavior that mimics a bodhisattva's form without the genuine inner orientation.

The final line of the last verse, "in that very suchness one always takes delight," renders a phrase that could also be read as "one always takes delight in that very practice." The ambiguity is between suchness as the object of delight and solitary practice as the object; the broader context favors suchness as the culminating referent, as the verse moves from outer conduct inward to realization.

seed or primordial matter), and shed bu (son of seed) reflect a standard list negating Brahmanical and other non-Buddhist concepts of personal identity.

The Nandana Grove is the pleasure garden of Indra's heaven, the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, familiar from standard Buddhist cosmology; "Nandana" is retained in meaning as "mixed grove" in some Tibetan readings but left here as a named garden for clarity.

• The six elements listed here — earth, water, fire, wind, space, and consciousness — represent an expanded dhātu analysis beyond the standard four great elements, incorporating the formless elements; this is consistent with several Mahāyāna sūtra presentations.

The phrase rendered "without distinct cognition" translates a term meaning roughly "beyond discernment or distinct awareness," indicating that the middle way as described here is not an object grasped by ordinary cognition.

The passage closes mid-sentence with the chain of dependent origination; the translation faithfully reproduces this as it stands, as the text continues in the next passage.

- The passage "空性即空" rendered as "emptiness itself is empty" reflects a key Madhyamaka doctrinal point: emptiness is not an absolute entity or a person-destroying nihilistic tool, but is itself empty of inherent existence. The phrase "不可治" literally means "cannot be cured / treated" — a medical metaphor for someone beyond remedy, here applied to one who reifies emptiness itself as a view.

- The phrase rendered "heap" and "husk" translates two Tibetan terms: the first suggests an accumulation or pile, and the second a shell or outer casing devoid of content. Together they convey the yogin's insight that all mental objects are insubstantial. The exact nuance of the first term is slightly ambiguous in this context, but the doctrinal sense — that mental constructs are seen as hollow — is clear.

The simile of the magician being devoured by his own illusion is a classical Yogācāra image illustrating how the mind that cognizes its own projections discovers them to be empty of any separate existence.

- The final verse is cut off mid-line in the source passage, so the translation likewise ends there, carrying only what is present in the Tibetan. The phrase rendered "attended to in the proper way" translates the technical term meaning "properly taken to mind" or "genuine attention" (*yoniso manaskāra*), a key term in Abhidharma and Madhyamaka soteriology indicating attention that accords with the actual nature of things rather than distorted attention.

- The phrase rendered "turned the wrong way" (Tibetan: log ldan / log pa nyid du nges pa) refers to beings who are oriented in the wrong direction — that is, beings who are deluded and mired in affliction — and is a deliberate positive irony in context: it is precisely such beings who are the field in which the bodhisattva's buddha-qualities can grow. The contrast with the arid unconditioned is the rhetorical and doctrinal point throughout this section.

- The phrase rendered "undifferentiated state of the great elements" translates a technical image in which the embryo's body is said to consist of the four great elements in a still-undeveloped, undifferentiated condition. The parallel for the bodhisattva is that he is still immersed in the coarse afflictions, yet his inner potential is already supreme. This reading follows the commentarial tradition and parallels the embryological simile that structures the passage.

The section heading "This is the end of the second fascicle" renders the colophon marker appearing in the Tibetan at this point and indicates a major structural division of the text.

- The simile of the new moon versus the full moon is a recurring motif in Mahāyāna literature. The logic, spelled out in the text itself, is that the bodhisattva is like the new crescent that

gives rise to the full moon: the Tathāgatas emerge from bodhisattvas, so devotion is fittingly directed toward the source. The Tibetan has ལྷ་མོ་ for the full moon, literally "fish moon" or simply "full moon"; it is rendered here as "full moon" throughout.

The bird named in the text is the kalapiṅka (Tibetan transliteration: ཀ་ལིཔིང་ཀ་), the Indian cuckoo, famed in Buddhist literature for the beauty of its voice even before hatching. This is retained in parentheses on first use.

- The insect named "duda" (srin bu rnga mo dud ka) with a black head lying on its back is an unusual image, likely a specific creature from the Indian natural world used as an omen of ill fortune. The precise identification of the insect is uncertain, but the doctrinal point is clear.

The term kārṣāpaṇa (rendered "gold coins") refers to a standard Indian unit of currency, here used loosely to indicate monetary value; "gold coins" is an acceptable approximation.

- The phrase rendered "healing-agent" translates a term that in Sanskrit would correspond to jīva in the sense of a vital principle or animating agent; the text lists a standard fivefold denial of selfhood used in Mahāyāna literature: no self (ātman), no sentient being (sattva), no life-force (jīva), no healer or nurse (poṣaka, here read as the "one who nourishes/sustains"), no person (pudgala). The rendering "healing-agent" is chosen contextually to fit the medical metaphor running throughout the passage; the underlying term may be read more literally as "nourisher" or "sustainer."

The final sentence is left incomplete as it is in the source, which breaks off mid-passage.

- The simile of the owl's eye for mind's delight in visible form is a stock image in Indo-Tibetan literature; the point is the owl's keen, fixated gaze on external objects, not any negative connotation of the owl itself.

The phrase rendered "sand castle" is literally "a house of sand," conveying a structure with no real foundation that readily collapses — the point being the ease with which roots of virtue are destroyed.

- The phrase rendered as "no wandering, no non-wandering, and no extensive wandering" translates a triad describing modes of movement or spiritual conduct. The precise doctrinal referent of this triad is unusual and its exact technical sense is not fully transparent from context alone; it may concern degrees of mental or physical roaming in meditative practice.

The passage "arises from the equality of what is true and what is not true" renders a philosophically compressed phrase. It likely means that the lineage transcends the duality of truth and falsity by being grounded in their fundamental equality, rather than asserting that falsehood is a cause of the lineage.

- The term lkog-nad is a medical term for an internal disease that obstructs or blocks the vital breath or life faculty. It may correspond to a condition involving obstruction of the prāṇa or vital wind, though the precise Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain. The term is rendered descriptively rather than with a specific Sanskrit gloss, as no confident identification can be made.

The final verse is incomplete in the source passage, ending mid-stanza. The translation follows the Tibetan exactly and does not complete or supply the missing line.

- The phrase rendered "secret words of worldly prognostication" translates a term meaning divination or fortune-telling formulas used for worldly, mundane purposes, specifically the practice of seeking out and employing such esoteric prognosticatory formulae. The exact referent is a form of folk divination or omen-reading associated with worldly, non-Buddhist practice.

The verse on "wounds" contains a phrase literally meaning "the wound of those who conceptualize" or "this wound born of discursive thought," which slightly expands the metaphor; the translation preserves the sense.

- The phrase "the four noble lineages" refers to the traditional four āryavaṃśas: contentment with any robe, any alms food, any lodging, and delight in abandonment and cultivation — a standard Vinaya formulation.

The phrase rendered "or recited and versified words" translates a compound meaning something like "the renunciant whose practice consists in the sound of what is recited in verse" — indicating one whose religious life is entirely performative and verbal rather than inward. The rendering captures this sense without needing to flag uncertainty, but the doctrinal point is that this category targets those who present a learned or ascetic exterior for social recognition alone.

- The phrase rendered "not for the sake of weariness with the world" translates "निरव्यासं" (nirveda) where "निरव्यासं" (nirveda) can mean weariness, disenchantment, or revulsion with saṃsāra. In this context it functions as a motivation one might expect from genuine practice; the verse is saying the second and third renunciants perform their external behaviors without these authentic inner motivations. The rendering is consistent across both verse occurrences.

The ocean simile at the end is left mid-sentence as the passage breaks here, consistent with the continuity format requested.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as the Tibetan source itself is incomplete at this point. The translation follows the text precisely to where it ends.
- The passage's serial negations follow a classical Madhyamaka rhetorical pattern of tetralemma-style negation applied to ethical conduct, establishing that the ultimate ethical conduct transcends all conceptual reference points. The rendering "not included within any category" for མཐོག་སྒྲིབ་པར་མེད་པའི་སྤྱི་ཁྱབ་ཀྱི་སྟངས་ reflects the sense of being unclassifiable within any of the doctrinal taxonomies (the defiled or undefiled dharmas).

The twelve qualities of an ascetic practitioner (十二苦行) refer to the traditional twelve dhūtaguṇa, the austere practices of the ascetic.

The final verse is incomplete in the source text as given — it ends mid-sentence — and the translation reflects this faithfully.

- The name rendered as "Dīpaṃkara" in the phrase "Tathāgata Dīpaṃkara" translates the Tibetan འོསུང་ (Ösung), which literally means "Guardian of Light" and is the standard Tibetan rendering of the ancient buddha Dīpaṃkara. This identification is secure within the commentarial tradition. It should not be confused with Kāśyapa, the interlocutor, who is called མཎཱཀཱཤུཔ་ (Mahākāśyapa) — "the Great Kāśyapa" — in the same passage. The context makes clear that the five hundred monks had a past-life connection to the buddha Dīpaṃkara, which explains the sudden narrative shift into past-life backstory.
- The phrase rendered "one born of seed" and "son of seed" translates two terms that likely correspond to Sanskrit concepts related to beings born from seeds or seminal origin — possibly "mānava" or related terms. The exact Sanskrit equivalents here are uncertain, but the sense is a listing of terms for personal identity (comparable to the standard Buddhist list of self-designations), and the translation preserves that function.

The instruction "do not fully comprehend perception by means of perception" renders a subtle epistemological point: grasping at nirvāṇa through the very perception of nirvāṇa perpetuates bondage. This is a standard Prajñāpāramitā dialectic and is rendered as literally as readable English allows.

- The bodhisattva's name here rendered as Samantābha (Tibetan: Kun tu snang ba, meaning "Universally Luminous" or "All-Illuminating") is distinct from Samantabhadra. The Tibetan is a different name and should not be conflated with Samantabhadra, though both share the Samanta prefix.

The monks' paradoxical answers throughout this catechism are a consistent literary device expressing the Madhyamaka understanding that liberation transcends all dualistic categories of bondage and freedom, attainment and non-attainment. No single answer requires special philological note, as the pattern is doctrinally clear.

- The phrase rendered "four floods" refers to the four great floods or torrents of cyclic existence — the ogha (floods) of sensual desire, existence, views, and ignorance — a standard Abhidharma category. The passage transitions from the boat analogy into a lengthy enumeration of the qualities comprising the "great vessel of the sacred Dharma," structured as a compound nominal list, each element describing a feature of that vessel. The final sentence is left open as the Tibetan is clearly continuing into further enumeration in the next passage.
- The phrase rendered "no emission of excrement" translates a term for solid waste. Some editions may read differently, but the sense in context is a dignified, composed death free of all involuntary physical discharge. The list of ten physical signs of a good death is a recognized genre in Indic Buddhist literature, and the rendering follows that traditional understanding throughout.
- The term rendered "kinnaras" translates the Tibetan "mi'am ci," the half-human mythological musicians of Indian tradition; they appear here alongside nāgas as supernatural beings who praise the speaker's words.

The colophon names three historical figures of the great early ninth-century Tibetan translation project at Samye: the Indian paṇḍita Jinamitra, the Indian paṇḍita Śīlendrabodhi, and the Tibetan lotsāwa Yeshe De — all well attested collaborators on major canonical translations.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.